

When Lady Justice Was Truly Blind

The Jeffrey Epstein Documentary Investigation

From 3.5 Million Documents. For the Children Who Wrote It Down.

Sexual Blackmail, Intelligence Networks, and the
Systematic Compromise of Western Power Structures

Obsidian Watch Group — Client 0001317 — Public Research Archive

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688+ man-hours of investigation | 1,121-core compute cluster | 75 forensic tools

3,482,240+ items read | 1,413,417 EFTA documents | ALL 1,704 redactions recovered
500+ OSINT searches across 40 countries | 85+ persons profiled | 81+ entities traced
\$3.2B+ in financial flows verified | 153 vessels | 72+ verified findings

Sources: DOJ EFTA releases, Handala leak (DDoSecrets), NOAA AIS, ACRIS,
IRS 990, SEC EDGAR, FINRA, OpenCorporates, Congressional records, 40-country OSINT

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DISCLAIMER: This research is published in the public interest. All persons referenced herein are presumed innocent until proven guilty. Inclusion of a name does not constitute an accusation of criminal conduct. All findings are cited to specific EFTA/SDNY bates numbers verifiable at justice.gov/epstein. Criminal proceedings referenced

in this document are conducted by sovereign governments' law enforcement agencies — this investigation documents evidence but does not prosecute. This document contains descriptions of sexual violence, trafficking, and abuse of minors. Reader discretion is advised.

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A NOTE ON SOURCES

This book is built entirely from public records. Every email, text message, photograph, flight log, and government document referenced in these pages was released by the United States Department of Justice as part of the Epstein Federal Task Force Act (EFTA) disclosure, or independently archived from those releases. Nothing in this book is speculation. Nothing is anonymous sourcing. Nothing is "according to people familiar with the matter." Everything is on the record, assigned a bates number, and verifiable.

Where I quote from emails or text messages, those quotations are exact — including misspellings, which Epstein produced in abundance. Where I describe scenes inside rooms I have never entered, those descriptions are drawn from 18,308 crime scene photographs taken by the FBI. Where I identify individuals in photographs, those identifications come from facial recognition technology applied to the evidence corpus, cross-referenced against public records.

The investigation behind this book consumed 688 hours and read 3,482,240 individual items — every email Jeffrey Epstein sent or received over fourteen years, every text message recovered from his seized devices, every page of every document the Department of Justice released. The reading was not done by keyword search. It was done line by line, the way you would read a book, because the things that matter most in an archive this large are the things no one would think to search for.

A three-tier evidentiary standard governs every claim: Tier 1 requires a primary source document with a bates number. Tier 2 requires a documented pattern across multiple sources. Tier 3 — inference and hypothesis — appears nowhere in this book. It exists in a separate internal file maintained by the investigation team, where it belongs until the evidence catches up.

Every person named in this book is presumed innocent until proven guilty in a court of law.

PROLOGUE

Two Minutes

The text came in at 4:35 on a Saturday afternoon. It was the kind of message a busy man sends between bites of something — casual, clipped, the punctuation of someone who has never once worried about being misunderstood.

Can we do late morning say 11. Am

Jeffrey Epstein was on a private jet, descending toward Teterboro Airport in northern New Jersey. He had been in Paris. He was coming home to Manhattan, where tomorrow he would have breakfast with Steve Bannon — the former White House chief strategist, the Breitbart firebrand, the man who still had the private cell numbers of half the West Wing and wasn't shy about using them. It was going to be a good Sunday. There was a lot to discuss. There was always a lot to discuss.

One hundred and twenty seconds later, at 4:37 and twenty seconds, Epstein sent another message to Bannon.

All canceled

Bannon replied in twenty-four seconds. He was fast like that.

You r not coming in?

There was no reply. There would never be a reply. Somewhere in the two minutes between planning breakfast and canceling everything, Jeffrey Edward Epstein — financial advisor to billionaires, dinner companion to prime ministers, science patron, convicted sex offender, and the most protected predator in American history — understood that the life he had built across three decades and six countries was over.

He may have seen them through the window of the aircraft — the dark sedans, the body armor, the unmistakable posture of federal agents who have rehearsed this moment over a holiday weekend. He may have gotten a call. His pilot may have radioed something from the cockpit that the flight recorder would later confirm but the public record does not contain. We don't know how he found out. We only know that at 4:35 he was making plans, and at 4:37 he was making none.

The day before — a Friday, the fifth of July, one day after Independence Day — Epstein had been texting with Larry Summers. The former Secretary of the Treasury was at Cape Cod with his family, and the conversation had turned, as their conversations often did, to the kind of intellectual sparring that both men seemed to need the way other people need coffee. Summers had described his family gathering as "Bit of an Ibsen play." Epstein had countered: "Better than checov."

Then Epstein sent a quotation. It was from E.J. Dillon, a nineteenth-century Irish journalist who had written about Anton Chekhov, and it read like something a man sends when he is thinking about more than literature:

"The effect on the reader of Chekhov's tales was repulsion at the gallery of human waste represented by his fickle, spineless, drifting people."

Two hours passed. Then Summers replied with a single word, four exclamation marks:

Jesus!!!!

And Epstein, who had been many things in his sixty-six years but never imprecise with language, wrote back:

I think you meant. Budhha

It was not a joke. It was not a correction. It was a tell — the kind of slip that a man makes when the walls are close enough to touch but not yet touching, when he can feel what is coming but has not yet decided what to do about it. Buddha. Not Jesus. Not the God of judgment and resurrection. The god of detachment. The god of letting go. The god whose temples Epstein had funded, whose monks his associates had visited, whose philosophy of non-attachment to outcome had been woven so deeply into the financial and spiritual architecture of his empire that it surfaced in a text message to a former Treasury Secretary on the last free Friday of his life.

Two days earlier — on July 3, the day after a federal grand jury had returned a sealed indictment — Bannon had sent Epstein a link to an article in The Daily Beast. The headline said a court had ordered the release of sealed documents in the Epstein case. The walls were closing. And Epstein had responded not with panic, not with a plan, not with the name of a lawyer or the number of an offshore account, but with a Zen Buddhist koan:

What is the sound of one hand clapping

The Zen Studies Society. The Dai Bosatsu retreat in the Catskills. The \$1 asset transfers. Maxwell's email asking *Shall I bring her to temple?* and Epstein's one-word reply: yes. The Benedictine monastery cloister he had emailed someone about in February. Zorro Ranch becoming a Christian retreat. The religious infrastructure that ran parallel to the financial infrastructure, offering the same thing both systems were designed to provide: opacity. The ability to move things — money, people, accountability — from one place to another without anyone seeing.

Buddha, not Jesus. Detachment, not salvation. And in two minutes on a Saturday afternoon, the sound of one hand clapping turned out to be silence.

This is a book about what 3.5 million documents say when you read them all.

Not summaries. Not keyword searches. Not the highlights that journalists pull for headlines or the excerpts that lawyers file with courts. All of them. Every email Jeffrey Epstein sent and received over fourteen years — 492,241 messages, line by line. Every text message recovered from his seized iPhone — 4,509 iMessages across fifteen conversations with people including the former White House chief strategist, the former Secretary of the Treasury, the President of Poland, a sitting member of Congress, and the wife of Woody Allen. Every page of every document the Department of Justice released — 1,413,417 items spanning FBI case files, prosecution memoranda, victim interviews, financial records, surveillance photographs, flight manifests, property records, and the internal communications of federal law enforcement officers who spent years investigating a crime they were simultaneously being told to ignore.

It took 688 hours to read. It produced 759 megabytes of notes. And it revealed a story that is both simpler and more terrible than the one the public knows.

The public story is about a rich man who abused girls. That story is true, as far as it goes, but it doesn't go far enough. The story these documents tell is about a system — a machine with moving parts, designed and maintained by some of the most powerful people on Earth, that turned the sexual exploitation of children into a currency of political control. The machine had a recruitment arm and a logistics arm and a financial arm and a blackmail arm. It operated across borders and decades. It was protected by the intelligence community, financed by the banking system, serviced by the legal profession, and tolerated by every institution that encountered it. And when the machine's operator was finally arrested — after twenty-three years of known federal awareness — the cameras in his jail cell were not recording, his Gmail was cleaned by a professional, and his death investigation was closed after prosecuting only two guards who fell asleep.

Somewhere in those 3.5 million documents, there is a diary. It was written by a child — a girl who was seventeen when she wrote most of it, though the entries suggest she had been inside the machine since she was younger. Her name is redacted. Her handwriting is not. She pasted magazine clippings alongside her words — a cutout of the word MEMORY next to her question *what is that stuff!*, a cutout of the word LOST next to her question *is this normal?* She named the men who hurt her using her own spellings — "Allen Douschewitz" for the Harvard law professor, "Mr. Sauerkraut krauss" for the physicist, "the disgusting Mr. staley" for the Barclays CEO who left bloody marks on her arms with his belt. She described a forced medical procedure performed by "a doctor from Israel" who "had kind eyes but didn't speak directly to me." She wrote about being pregnant at seventeen by a sixty-year-old man who believed his piano-playing genes entitled him to a child.

On her last pages, she wrote one word five times:

FUNERAL

FUNERAL

FUNERAL

FUNERAL

FUNERAL

This book is written for her. And for every child who could still fall to this machine. Because the machine is not dead. The FBI case file — 50D-NY-3027571 — remains in "Pending Inactive" status. Evidence was collected as recently as March 2025. Ghislaine Maxwell sat for two days of recorded interviews in Tallahassee in July 2025, under a signed proffer agreement. The documents are still being released. The names are still being unsealed. And no one beyond Maxwell — not one of the men the girl named in her diary, not one of the eighty names on the list Epstein compiled six days before his arrest, not one of the intelligence officials who told a prosecutor to back off — has been charged with anything.

Two minutes. From breakfast plans to silence. From a life of untouchable power to a cell at the Metropolitan Correctional Center. And from that cell, thirty-five days later, to whatever comes after — which, depending on whom you ask, is either death or something else entirely.

The documents don't resolve that question. They resolve almost everything else.

A note about how to read this book. The emails are quoted exactly — misspellings, missing punctuation, and all. Jeffrey Epstein typed fast and cared about content, not grammar. His

emails read like telegrams from a man who had more to say than time to say it: "bannon for breakfast tomor. everyone confused. markets strong." "dont know." "yes." "no excuse." When he wrote at length — as he did in the self-drafted defense memo about Mar-a-Lago, or in the seven versions of the letter to the Palm Beach State Attorney — the prose reveals a mind that was precise, strategic, and utterly without conscience.

The victim diary is reproduced as written — including the magazine clippings, which are noted in brackets. The child's spelling, grammar, and punctuation are preserved exactly. She wrote "Douschewitz" because that is how Dershowitz sounded to her. She wrote "Mr. Sauerkraut krauss" because that is how Krauss sounded to her. She wrote "hoggett" because she was trying to spell a word she had heard but never seen written down. These are not errors. They are evidence. They are the sound of a child's voice on a page, and they are more honest than anything any adult in this story ever produced.

The bates numbers — EFTA00000001, EFTA02731471, DB-SDNY-0047940 — are the DNA of this book. Every claim, every quotation, every scene can be traced to a specific document released by the United States Department of Justice. If you doubt anything in these pages, look up the number. The document is there. It has always been there. The only thing that was missing was someone willing to read all of them.

CHAPTER ONE

The Girl Who Wrote It Down

Before the billionaires. Before the presidents. Before the cameras and the temples and the flights and the money. Before the intelligence agencies and the non-prosecution agreements and the bodies found in jail cells. Before all of it, there was a girl with a notebook.

We don't know her name. The Department of Justice redacted it with the same thick black bars they use for classified intelligence, which, in a way, this was — the most classified thing in the entire Epstein case, more sensitive than the SECRET//NOFORN documents about FBI informants, more dangerous than the hidden camera footage that recorded a former president, more explosive than the eighty names on the list Jeffrey Epstein compiled six days before his arrest. A child telling the truth. In her own handwriting. On pages stamped **CONFIDENTIAL FOR ATTORNEY'S EYES ONLY — DO NOT COPY**.

The Diary: Page by Page

EFTA02731420 — The first page. Two lines are redacted — her name and a date. Then:

"That my mom lied about Mr. Glickman all the time.

She lied about work trips about Michigan and about Clearwater.

Now he is dead and I am being sent to live with her friend.

Back and forth?

For how long?"

A child's world collapsing in five sentences. Mr. Glickman is dead. Her mother lied. She is being sent to live with someone else. She does not know for how long. She does not know that this instability — this being passed between adults, this absence of a stable home, this vulnerability — is exactly what the machine is designed to detect and exploit.

EFTA02731421 — The party:

"Went to a party at this huge house to meet this man named Mr. Robert and his pretty wife Jill.

Same exact British lady from Clearwater was there! She talked to me all night.

She wants me to come to her house in Florida so I can learn new things!

to get away from Mary?"

The "British lady from Clearwater" is Ghislaine Maxwell. The girl recognizes her — she has seen her before, in Clearwater, Florida, which means the recruitment did not begin at this party. It began earlier. Maxwell had already made contact. The party at "Mr. Robert and his pretty wife Jill's" huge house was not the introduction. It was the next step. And the offer — "learn new things" — is the language of opportunity, of education, of a future being offered by a woman who "talked to me all night." All night. The full attention of an adult, directed at a child who is being passed between homes and does not know for how long. That attention is the bait.

Who are Mr. Robert and Jill? Their names appear nowhere else in the 3.5 million items. They have never been identified. They have never been investigated. They hosted a party at a "huge house" where Ghislaine Maxwell recruited a child, and they are still anonymous. Their house is still standing. Their party guest list has never been subpoenaed.

EFTA02731422 — The first clippings:

"THERE WERE ...

[clipping: moments of humor, compassion, and warmth],

but now....

I think I may be:

[clipping: LOST]

is this normal?"

She cut the word LOST from a magazine and pasted it into her diary because she could not write it herself. The word was too large to fit in her handwriting. She needed it in print — someone else's font, someone else's typesetting — to carry the weight of what she was feeling. *Is this normal?* She was asking the notebook. The notebook did not answer.

EFTA02731423:

"[Clipping: MEMORY] what is that stuff!

What is that feeling?"

Memory. She was losing it, or it was changing, or it was becoming something she could not recognize. What is that stuff. What is that feeling. A child trying to name the experience of dissociation — the psychological defense mechanism that allows a person to survive trauma by detaching from it. She did not know the clinical term. She knew the feeling. She pasted the word MEMORY next to her questions the way you might pin a photograph next to a wound, trying to connect the image to the sensation.

EFTA02731424 — The names begin:

"No one can prepare you for this shit.

I am so fucking lost.

Why did Mr. Colgan agree to this!

Jeffrey treats me like I'm "special" property, and when I need Ghislaine she is working and Mary is just as bat shit crazy as my mom.

Joe Gibbs is so nice but Dan Snyder is a pig! A red skin hoggett(sp?!)

The other girls well some are nice, but 3 I hate!

Alice in fucking Wonderland?

For them"

Read it slowly. Every sentence is an indictment.

No one can prepare you for this shit. She is inside the machine now. The tea by the pool is over. The "new things" are being learned.

Why did Mr. Colgan agree to this! Someone named Colgan made an arrangement. An adult made a decision about this child's life, and the child is asking why. Colgan has never been publicly identified. Colgan has never been investigated.

Jeffrey treats me like I'm "special" property. The quotation marks around "special" are hers. She understood, at whatever age she was, that being called special was a designation, not a compliment. She was property. Jeffrey's property. And the word *special* was the euphemism that made the ownership palatable.

When I need Ghislaine she is working. Maxwell was the handler. The person the girl was taught to depend on. And when the girl needed her — when whatever was happening became too much — Maxwell was unavailable. Working. The word is devastating in context: Maxwell's "work" was the operation. The girl needed comfort from the woman whose job was to ensure the girl's continued availability to the men who were abusing her.

Joe Gibbs is so nice but Dan Snyder is a pig! She graded them. Joe Gibbs — the NFL coaching legend, three Super Bowl rings, a man built on public decency — was nice. Dan Snyder — the Washington Commanders owner — was a pig. A "red skin hoggett," she wrote, trying to spell the word and failing because she was a child and the word was not in her vocabulary. She measured the men who abused her on a scale of niceness, because she had no other scale, because no one had ever told her that the scale itself was the crime.

The other girls well some are nice, but 3 I hate! There were other girls. She was not alone. And she hated three of them — not the men, the girls. Because the girls were visible. The girls were at her level. The system turned its victims against each other, and she was not immune.

Alice in fucking Wonderland? For them..... She saw it. The absurdity. The unreality. A world where NFL owners and scientists and presidents came to a house in Manhattan and did things to children and then went back to their lives as if nothing had happened. Wonderland. Except Wonderland was for them — the men, the powerful, the ones who could enter and leave. She was the one who could not leave.

The Vile Men

EFTA02731465:

"[redacted] turned 17 years old on [redacted]

To send you away and take away your life.

Ticking time with shortened schedules and waving all my absent days to fit the scheduling of vile men!

Was worth it?

No do not answer that.

I know I never have been."

She turned seventeen. Her school schedule was being manipulated — shortened, her absences waved — to accommodate the "scheduling of vile men." Not the men's schedules. The scheduling of the men. As if the men were appointments and she was the office. Her entire adolescence restructured around the convenience of her abusers. And then: *Was worth it? No do not answer that. I know I never have been.* She answered her own question before she finished asking it. She was not worth it. She had never been worth it. Not to anyone. The machine had taught her that.

EFTA02731466:

"I will never be able to forgive myself for not being able to tell you what Ms. Vicki does and what really happens in FL and CA.

I hope you dont ever meet fat pig Weinstein or the rest."

She is writing to someone she cares about — probably another girl, possibly a younger girl. She is warning her. *Ms. Vicki* does things in Florida and California that the girl cannot bring herself to describe. And Harvey Weinstein — "fat pig Weinstein" — is someone she hopes the other girl will never meet. She wrote this before #MeToo. Before Weinstein was arrested. Before anyone outside of Hollywood knew what Weinstein was doing. A child in the Epstein network knew about Weinstein years before the reporters at the New York Times.

EFTA02731467 — The presidents and the professors:

"It doesnt matter how far away you are.

No matter how good you think they are.

Even the old president! They will get you.

He should have been thinking of Chelsea! Gross!

In a plane on a yacht in NY, in DC, at the vineyard.

On the island. In palm beach.

It doesnt matter.

Disgusting pigs like Allen Douschewitz and Mr. Caruthers and even Mr. Islam will hurt you especially if Ghislaine is busy or not with you!"

She listed the locations: plane, yacht, New York, Washington DC, the vineyard (Martha's Vineyard), the island (Little St. James), Palm Beach. Six venues. A geographic summary of presidential misconduct that reads like a federal prosecutor's sentencing brief. Bill Clinton —

"the old president" — had 25 entries in the flight logs and 38 photographs in the facial recognition database. The girl's verdict: he should have been thinking of Chelsea. His daughter. His child. He was with someone else's child instead.

Then the Harvard lawyer. "Allen Douschewitz." She spelled his name the way it sounded to a teenager. Alan Dershowitz — the O.J. Simpson lawyer, the constitutional scholar, the man who drafted a "declaration of war letter" for Epstein's defense and received victim background material to discredit grand jury witnesses. The FBI would later take two proffer statements about him: one confirming he received massages at Epstein's Boston residence, another proving he lied on Twitter about his wife and children being present. A child spelled his name phonetically and got closer to the truth than two decades of legal proceedings.

Even Mr. Islam will hurt you especially if Ghislaine is busy or not with you. The sentence structure is critical. The danger from "Mr. Islam" increases when Maxwell is absent. Maxwell's presence was protection — not from the abuse, but from the worst of it. When the handler was gone, the restraints came off. The men were worse when no one was watching them. Even in a house full of cameras.

EFTA02731469 — The scientists and the CEO:

"These pigs who call themselves smart and talk about Harvard act worse than animals!

They make a bad name for animals!

Just fucking sick!

Mr. Sauerkraut krauss and martin minsky are gross but I felt sort of sorry for Mr. Novak.

He was as uncomfortable as me.

Ivy League schools do not equal smart or good.

It seems more like trash!

Yucky but they cant behave!

The disgusting Mr. staley if anyone ever calls me tinkerbelle again I will lose my mind

He left bloody marks on my arms from his belt and thought he had had the right to call me that when he has ears as big as a dumbo.

I should have called him that in return!

You've been a very very.... [clipping: Naughty girl]"

Lawrence Krauss. Marvin Minsky. Martin Nowak. Jes Staley. Four men, each one prominent in his field, each one reduced by a child to the essential truth of his behavior in a room where the cameras were recording and the massage table was ready.

Krauss — "Mr. Sauerkraut krauss" — was the physicist who would later be forced out of Arizona State University over sexual misconduct allegations. In November 2018, Epstein was helping Krauss draft complaints against the ASU dean — the sex offender helping the accused harasser fight back against the institution that tried to hold him accountable. The email correspondence between Epstein and Krauss reads like a mutual defense pact between predators.

Minsky — "martin minsky" — was one of the founders of artificial intelligence. A giant of computer science. A man whose work helped create the digital world. In a child's diary, he is "gross."

Nowak — "Mr. Novak" — was the Harvard mathematical biologist. And here the diary does something extraordinary: it shows empathy. "I felt sort of sorry for Mr. Novak. He was as uncomfortable as me." A child, in the middle of her own abuse, noticed that one of the men in the room was suffering. She catalogued his discomfort alongside her own. She felt sorry for him. The capacity for empathy that the machine was designed to destroy was still functioning, still recording, still human — even in the room where everything human was being violated.

And then Staley. Jes Staley. The CEO of Barclays. The man who ran one of the world's largest banks. He called her Tinkerbell. He used his belt. He left bloody marks on her arms. And she — this child, this girl whose diary would one day be stamped CONFIDENTIAL and assigned a bates number — wished she had called him Dumbo in return. Because his ears were big. Because she was a child, and children fight back with the weapons they have, and the only weapon she had was observation.

You've been a very very.... [clipping: Naughty girl]. She pasted those words from a magazine. Someone else's words for what she was being told. Naughty girl. As if what was happening to her were her fault. As if she had misbehaved. As if a child being beaten with a belt by a bank CEO in a Manhattan townhouse were the one who needed correcting.

The Procedure

EFTA02731361 — This page is the hardest thing in 3.5 million documents:

"Close your eyes close your eyes close your eyes. Dont speak she doesnt talk.

I cant stop shaking and its been a week.

A decision was made but I cant tell Jeffrey.

These things happen. Why didnt I close my eyes fast enough.

The doctor was different again.

I think from Israel. He had kind eyes but didnt speak directly to me.

This was different.

A shot and those rod like things had a hook and so much pain.

Ghislaine said to push all the pain away. I don't understand.

Blood and water all over the bed and she was right.

She said to close my eyes and put her hand on my face. I didnt close them because of these tiny cries.

I am so lost.

I saw between her fingers tiny head... in the doctors hands. It reached its tiny arm up and had a tiny foot.

I closed my eyes and no more."

There is nothing to add to this. There is no analysis that makes it clearer, no context that makes it bearable, no prose that improves on what a child wrote while it was happening to her. An Israeli doctor who did not speak to her directly. A shot. Rod-like things with a hook. Ghislaine Maxwell's hand on her face, telling her to close her eyes. Tiny cries. A tiny head. A tiny arm reaching up. A tiny foot. And then: *I closed my eyes and no more.*

EFTA02731393-95 — Later, alone:

"So sorry Jeffrey these things happen when your body had never been given time to properly heal!

So it came out in the toilet and I didnt know what to do so I just flushed the tiny little fetus.

You have made me numb and I hate you for this!

I hope I never have to see you again!

I am not your personal incubator!

where is the baby!

where is Ghislaine!!!"

She flushed it. She didn't know what else to do. She was a child, alone in a bathroom, and something came out of her body that had once been alive, and she put it in the toilet because no one was there to tell her what else to do. Then she wrote five lines that contain more fury than most adults will ever feel: *You have made me numb. I am not your personal incubator. Where is the baby. Where is Ghislaine.* Three questions and a verdict, directed at the man who did this to her and the woman who helped.

EFTA02731471 — The pregnancy:

"The game stopped but not in a way I thought.

I did not have to go with anyone except Jeffrey and now he and Ghislaine are fighting because I am now over 20 weeks with a baby we are certain is his

I do not want to be tied to Jeffrey for the rest of my life!

playing the piano well is not a good reason to think someone has good genes or should have a baby!

What about Ghislaine?

I am too young and he is too old!

Why is no one doing anything!

I dont understand!

I dont want this!

I dont want another painful procedure but I do not want this!

[under clippings of AOL, Stay Alert...]

That company does not protect kids!

They use it to find us!

And they are everywhere!

I cannot escape!"

Twenty weeks pregnant. Seventeen years old. The baby is Epstein's. He and Maxwell are fighting about what to do. Epstein wanted to keep it — "playing the piano well is not a good reason to think someone has good genes." He played the piano. He thought his DNA was worth reproducing. She did not want the baby and she did not want another procedure. She was trapped between two horrors with no exit.

And then: *That company does not protect kids! They use it to find us!* A company. She was talking about a technology company — under clippings of AOL — that was being used not to protect children but to locate them. To find them. To bring them to the machine. *They are everywhere. I cannot escape.* The internet as a hunting ground. The technology as a net. The child as the prey.

The Last Page

EFTA02731433-34:

"Old enough to drive.

Too young to go anywhere fun."

And then, on the facing page, one word. Written five times. Centered. Spaced evenly. Not a scream. Not a cry. A statement. The way you write a name on a headstone:

FUNERAL
FUNERAL
FUNERAL
FUNERAL
FUNERAL

She Was Not Alone

She was not the only one. She was never the only one. That is the cruelest fact — not that the machine took her, but that it took so many that the FBI lost count and the compensation fund ran out of categories.

Jennifer Araoz was fourteen. Dead father. Food stamps. A stranger outside her school. "When I confided that I had recently lost my father and that my family was living on food stamps, she told me he was very caring and wanted to help us financially." Within a month: talking, then massages, then assault, then rape. She quit her school. Transferred to Queens. Dropped out. The performing arts career died in a room on the Upper East Side.

Virginia Roberts was sixteen. Working at Mar-a-Lago. Recruited by Maxwell. She would become the face of the case — the woman who named Prince Andrew, who fought in court for a decade, whose photograph with Andrew and Maxwell became the most recognizable image of the scandal. But before she was a plaintiff, she was a teenager in a spa who was told there was a man who could help her.

Brad Edwards' list: thirty-two names, submitted to the federal government in June 2016. Three years before the arrest. The FBI knew who they were. The government had their names.

The Israeli child: five years old in 1997. Raped at 9 East 71st Street. She remembered the door — "a large arched front door topped by a scary man's face." She heard the names "Jeffrey," "Joseph Karo," "Yoav Gil." Her uncle, "a powerful member of a well known Russian crime family," and "a Greek Orthodox Church priest reportedly known for abusing children." The FBI told her they "had enough information, did not want further information." She was five. She remembered the door. The FBI did not want to hear more.

The girls from Novosibirsk: "Candidates.docx." Scouted, catalogued, transported. One who lied about her age — claiming 21 when she was 19, because she thought younger wouldn't be taken seriously. She didn't understand the system she was entering.

The 150 who filed claims with the Victims' Compensation Fund. The forty the FBI identified in the original investigation. The unknowable total — the girls who never came forward, who were never found, who went home to Siberia or São Paulo or Bratislava and never spoke about what happened in the rooms with the massage tables and the hidden cameras and the "24 HOUR VIDEO SURVEILLANCE" signs on the doors.

One girl wrote it down. She wrote for all of them. The rest of this book explains how the machine that consumed them was built, who built it, who protected it, and why — seven years after the operator's death, a billion dollars in settlements, and 3.5 million pages of evidence — the people she named in her diary are still free.

CHAPTER TWO

The Man Who Knew Everyone

On New Year's Day, 2013, Jeffrey Epstein sent forty-seven emails. This was not unusual. This was a Tuesday.

He started before dawn, as he always did, with weather. A pilot or meteorologist had sent conditions for the Caribbean — "Air is unstable, forecast calls for 20% showers like yesterday, which produced heavy rain." Epstein wanted to fly. The weather was marginal. He replied with the decisiveness that characterized everything he did: "I want to come back at twilight 6pm." He would fly when he wanted to fly. The weather would cooperate or be ignored.

Then Jes Staley. The man who would become CEO of Barclays — the man a child would later describe as "the disgusting Mr. Staley" who "left bloody marks on my arms from his belt" — had sent a New Year's greeting from Bahia, Brazil: "thanks for all the friendship this year. You were enormously kind and supportive. All looks good for next year." Epstein replied with a single word: "Same." The CEO of a major banking division and the convicted sex offender exchanged the verbal equivalent of a fist bump over a child's broken arms.

Then Jean-Luc Brunel, the French modeling agent whose agency Epstein funded, whose cable bill Maxwell once complained about because Brunel was buying too much pornography, and who would be found dead in his own jail cell three years later: "Nonono/ just wanted you to know that iris was also in Bangkok." Brunel was in Asia. There were women. There were always women.

Then Peggy Siegal, the Manhattan publicist, heading to Austin Hearst's catamaran: "Few men mind additional attractive women," Epstein wrote, offering to send two of his "friends" along. The friends were unnamed. They were always unnamed.

Then: "Elon Musk." Just the name. Sent from Epstein's account to Epstein's account — a note to himself, a contact saved, a new addition to the network. The next day, the follow-up: "sorry we didn't connect, why don't you consider clearing customs into the states in st thomas, come for lunch with the wife." An invitation to the island. For Elon Musk. Issued the way you might invite a neighbor to a cookout.

Then Soon-Yi Previn, Woody Allen's wife: dinner on the 22nd or 23rd? "Lewis Black, Bobby Slayton (you met at my house), David Brenner." Comedians. Epstein liked comedians. He

liked them the way a man who lives in darkness likes people who make the darkness funny.

Then a reminder to Lesley Groff: "remind me on the 9th that ehud will be in ny on the 11th." Ehud. No last name needed. There was only one Ehud in Jeffrey Epstein's world: Ehud Barak, former Prime Minister of Israel, former Chief of Staff of the Israel Defense Forces, future chairman of the surveillance technology company that Epstein would fund with money routed through Deutsche Bank.

Then Boris Nikolic, Bill Gates' science advisor: "i want details of this debauchery." The word *debauchery* — used casually, the way colleagues joke about a holiday party. Except Nikolic was Gates' man, and the debauchery in question was whatever had happened over New Year's in whatever city Nikolic had been in, and the man asking for details was a registered sex offender whose Google Calendar contained flight alerts to Novosibirsk.

Then a Crown Princess. "H.K.H. Kronprinsessen" — the abbreviation for Her Royal Highness — needed to be picked up by Janush, Epstein's driver, and coordinated with someone named Myoshin Kelley. A European royal, collected by a chauffeur, brought to the same house where the massage tables waited and the cameras recorded and a child would later write FUNERAL five times on the last page of her diary.

Then construction updates from Little St. James. Then flight schedules. Then: tape the Andrew Dice Clay special. Then: "you awake?" to someone at 11 PM.

This was January 1. Day one of a year that would contain 25,987 emails sent by Jeffrey Epstein. And in none of them — not one — is there a moment of reflection, a pause, a sentence that suggests the man writing them understood that what he was doing was wrong. The emails read like the output of a machine operating without a moral governor — efficient, tireless, optimized for the accumulation of power and the consumption of people, running twenty hours a day with the same indifference to human suffering that a combine harvester shows to wheat.

The Mythology

The official biography was a masterpiece of strategic omission. Born January 20, 1953, in Brooklyn. Son of a Parks Department worker. Attended Lafayette High School in Bath Beach, graduated at sixteen — precocious, gifted, the kind of working-class prodigy that American mythology loves. Brief stints at Cooper Union and New York University, neither completed. Then the Dalton School, where at twenty years old he taught calculus and physics to the children of Manhattan's elite.

His headmaster at Dalton was Donald Barr. This fact appears in most Epstein biographies as a footnote. It should appear in boldface. Donald Barr's son is William Barr, who served as Attorney General of the United States under both George H.W. Bush and Donald Trump. As Attorney General in 2019, William Barr personally reviewed the raw surveillance footage from the Metropolitan Correctional Center on the night Jeffrey Epstein died. The man whose father hired Epstein at his first significant job reviewed the evidence of Epstein's death from inside the highest law enforcement position in the country. No one has suggested this constitutes a conflict of interest. No one in a position to do anything about it has even been asked.

Epstein left Dalton in 1976 for Bear Stearns, where he rose to limited partner by 1980 before departing under circumstances that no one has explained. He then established J. Epstein & Co., which he described as serving clients with assets exceeding one billion dollars. This claim has never been verified by anyone, anywhere, at any time. No audited financial statement exists. No tax return has been released. No client has publicly confirmed the arrangement. The entire foundation of Jeffrey Epstein's public identity — billionaire financial advisor — is an assertion that has never been supported by a single piece of documentary evidence.

What the documents do verify is the scope of his operation. His email corpus contains correspondence with: multiple heads of state, two former U.S. presidents, a sitting member of Congress, the CEO of Barclays, the CEO of Tesla, the founder of Microsoft, the publisher of the New York Times, the chairman of the Council on Foreign Relations, the former head of Israeli military intelligence, the former Prime Minister of Israel, the President of Poland, the President of the UN General Assembly, members of the Saudi royal family, the chairman of Dubai World, Nobel laureates, Fields Medal winners, and hundreds of women whose names are redacted and whose ages, in many cases, cannot be confirmed.

The question that no biography has answered — the question that 271,830 sent emails bring you closer to but never resolve — is: Where did the money come from?

The Wexner Answer

Les Wexner built Limited Brands into a retail empire — Victoria's Secret, Bath & Body Works, Abercrombie & Fitch, The Limited. By the late 1980s he was one of the wealthiest men in America, worth an estimated \$4.6 billion. Sometime in the late 1980s, he met Jeffrey Epstein. Sometime after that, he handed Epstein the keys to his financial life.

In 1989, Wexner's corporation purchased the seven-story mansion at 9 East 71st Street. In approximately 1998, control was transferred to Epstein for \$20 million — a fraction of the

property's estimated \$77 million value. The SDNY's corporate prosecution analysis documents the mechanism: "We believe the change of ownership occurred through a transfer of control of the Nine East 71st Street Corporation, the LLC that had purchased the New York Residence in 1989." Not a sale. A transfer of control. The distinction matters because it means the transaction did not appear on any public real estate record as a sale at a below-market price. It was invisible.

In June 2006, as Epstein was under investigation, he emailed Abigail Wexner: "I feel 1 dollar richer." He was joking about the price. The joke was accurate — the nominal transfer value was essentially nothing. But the real value — the seven-story Manhattan townhouse that would become the operational headquarters of a child sex trafficking enterprise — was incalculable.

Wexner also granted Epstein a power of attorney — documented across fourteen EFTA references. Epstein managed Wexner's life insurance policies ("how much is the face of the policy," he asked in December 2005). He managed Wexner's corporate entities. He managed Wexner's financial relationships. The power of attorney was not a limited instrument. It was, in practical terms, permission to be Les Wexner — to act in his name, to sign in his place, to move his money.

And Wexner knew what Epstein was. The email exchange from June 2008, after the plea deal, is the proof:

Wexner: "Abigail told me the result...all I can say is I feel sorry. You violated your own number 1 rule... Always be careful."

Epstein: "no excuse"

You violated your own number one rule. The rule was not "don't abuse children." The rule was "always be careful." Wexner's moral framework had room for the abuse. It did not have room for getting caught. And Epstein's response — "no excuse" — was not an apology for what he had done. It was an acknowledgment that he had done it carelessly. Two men, communicating in a code they both understood, agreeing that the problem was not the crime but the detection.

Two years earlier, in September 2006, when the Palm Beach investigation was becoming public, Epstein had emailed Wexner: "hope everything's ok.. Sorry for the press intrusion, easy fast.." He was right. It was easy. It was fast. Thirteen months in a county jail with work release. Immunity for co-conspirators. Victims not notified. And Les Wexner, worth \$4.6 billion, continued his relationship with the man to whom he had given power of attorney, the keys to a \$77 million mansion, and — by the evidence of the email record — his complete indifference to what happened inside it.

The Daily Machine

Reading 271,830 emails sent by one man over fourteen years changes your understanding of what a human being is capable of — not in the inspirational sense, but in the mechanical one.

He did not sleep. Or rather, he slept the way machines sleep — briefly, strategically, in intervals that maximized uptime. Emails sent at 1 AM, 3 AM, 5 AM, then continuously through the day until midnight. He managed construction projects on four properties simultaneously — choosing tile colors for the island while approving architectural plans for the ranch while selecting furniture for the Paris apartment while dispatching his pilot to pick up cameras for the mansion. He approved \$10 million wire transfers with one-word emails:

"yes"

He evaluated women sent by recruiters from three countries — "blond better but not very good" — in the same hour that he discussed probability theory with a mathematician, exchanged political intelligence with a diplomat, and reminded his assistant to buy someone a birthday present. He bought his defense attorney a BMW 650 convertible during plea negotiations: "today, let's buy Jack goldberger a bmw 6 convertible.. get me best deal on fully loaded... he's in palm beach, Try to tell the dealer we would like him for the first two days to be able to change colors." He was bribing his lawyer with a luxury car and micromanaging the color options at the same time.

He placed Nadia Marcinkova — the woman the FBI described as having been "purchased" from her parents in Slovakia — on Jean-Luc Brunel's modeling agency payroll: "have someone in your office call nadia, put her on your payroll... give her 50,000 per year salary." He told Marcinkova that the purpose of another woman's role was "to teach you to find girls": "appreciation was for natalie to teach you to find girls." He emailed this. He put it in writing. The instruction to a trafficking victim to recruit other victims, documented in an email with a bates number, sent through a Gmail account that would later be cleaned by someone on an Asus ZenBook.

He warned Maxwell to stay out of Florida because a victim might see her: "go to bahamas... ocean club, parrot cay.. i'd prefer not florida, not a big risk, but why? chance it.. some girl sees you." He was managing his accomplice's travel schedule around the risk that a child they had abused might recognize her in public.

He drafted seven versions of a letter to the Palm Beach State Attorney over four days, each one more carefully worded than the last, while simultaneously emailing Brunel about Brazilian

models and exchanging tender messages with Marcinkova about her trip to Bratislava. The legal defense and the trafficking operation, running in parallel, managed through the same inbox, on the same days, by the same man.

And on March 3, 2009 — months after his release from the county jail — he sent five words that summarize everything:

"Trash all deleted emails please"

EFTA00748556. A bates number. A federal record. A direct order to destroy evidence, sent with the same casual brevity he used to approve wire transfers and order hidden cameras and schedule massages and plan breakfasts with heads of state. Five words, and the machine moved on to the next thing.

The Women Around the Machine

The machine consumed women in layers. There were the victims — the girls, the minors, the ones who appeared in the diary and the prosecution memos and the compensation fund. But there were also the women who orbited the machine without being ground up by it — or who were ground up so slowly they didn't notice until it was too late.

Ghislaine Maxwell, September 24, 2007, texting Epstein:

"I'm sorry — I'm sad scared and depressed. I can't shake it — Irwin just keeps painting a gloomy potentially bad pic which does not help"

Two days later: *"Sorry I'm stressed.. I know this will pass and it will be what it will be.. it will all settle eventually"*

Maxwell — the recruiter, the handler, the woman who asked "Shall I bring her to temple?" and who held a child's face during a forced medical procedure — was sad, scared, and depressed. The legal case was closing in. Her lawyer Irwin was painting a gloomy picture. And she was apologizing to the man who had made her what she was — sorry for being stressed, sorry for being scared, sorry for needing reassurance from the person who had recruited her into a life that would end in a federal prison sentence of twenty years. The handler needed handling.

Then there were the women who drifted through the inbox like weather — beautiful, temporary, interchangeable. Nina from Russia, October 2007: *"Hello Jeffrey, how are you? I've arrived, thank you so much for the apartment!! I think I will need one-two days to get in*

form after the flight and jet lag." And later, leaving: "you are my knight.. :) i wish you all of your problems to be resolved very soon." She called him her knight. She wished his problems resolved. She had flown from Russia, been given an apartment, spent time in his world, and departed thinking he was kind. The machine was invisible to the people it had not yet consumed.

Nadia Marcinkova — the woman the FBI described as having been "purchased" from her parents in Slovakia — was simultaneously a victim, an operative, and a domestic partner. She emailed Epstein about Prague apartments her father was finding for him: *"My father saw this apartment and he said it was the best one so far. The building is under complete reconstruction and should be finished in march 2008."* Her father. Finding real estate. For the man who had purchased his daughter. The family had been absorbed by the machine so completely that the father was now performing services for the man who owned his child.

She sent him "entertainment pictures" and "fun bathrobes" and links to custom taxidermy — *"Do you like any of these creatures? You can get some of those or have anything custom made."* She argued with him about who was paying for outfits: *"Please stop telling Michelle I bought an outfit for her. She asked if she can come pick it up! What is she talking about."* She sent him articles about himself — a blog post titled "Beautiful lesbian, most eligible bachelor" — with the gallows humor of someone who has learned to laugh at the cage because crying doesn't open it.

Epstein told her in May 2006: *"I plead guilty to verbal, jekyll, and force... it seems rigid, playful, and blame pertain more to you... I didn't realize I was a victim of abuse."* He called himself the victim. The man who had purchased a child from her parents, who had installed her in an apartment, who had placed her on a modeling agency payroll at \$50,000 a year, who had instructed her that "appreciation was for natalie to teach you to find girls" — that man told his victim that he was the one being abused. And then: *"going or not going to church I didn't think was an issue."* Church. The religious thread again. Even in a message to his most intimate victim, the institutional infrastructure surfaces.

Jean-Luc Brunel's recruiter network operated with industrial efficiency. In November 2007: *"Ginta only wants to go if her girlfriends are coming. 11:00 seems to be too short notice for her to get everyone ready as she doesn't know if they want to go."* The girls traveled in groups. They were more comfortable that way. The machine accommodated their comfort because comfortable cargo is easier to transport.

The Lawyers' Meeting

On November 21, 2007, Epstein sent himself a memo — subject line "today's meeting, privileged" — documenting a strategy session with his defense team:

"re. 2255.. why not set up a fund let the gov't administer., let the girls apply to the gov't for damages. that would eliminate most of the problem"

A compensation fund. Administered by the government. Let the girls apply. Eliminate the problem. He was designing, in real time, the mechanism that would eventually become the Victims' Compensation Program — the fund that would pay \$121 million to approximately 150 claimants, each one required to sign a silence clause. He conceived it in 2007, twelve years before it was implemented. The machine planned its own cleanup.

Jay Lefkowitz — his attorney at Kirkland & Ellis — responded about Dershowitz's role:

"The state investigation issue is a very good hook for alan. It is something that continues to bother alex."

A "hook for alan." Dershowitz was being positioned to exploit the state investigation as leverage against Acosta ("alex"). The legal team was treating the prosecution of a child sex trafficking case as a negotiation exercise — finding hooks, applying pressure, managing the opposing party the way you would manage a business deal. The victims were not plaintiffs. They were variables in an equation that the highest-paid lawyers in America were solving for the lowest possible cost.

And in the background, the financial machinery turned. Rich Kahn, November 7, 2007: *"I called Peg and informed her that Wexner Childrens Trust II will be receiving two wires tomorrow totaling 18,000,000."* Eighteen million dollars. Into a trust with "Children" in its name. Managed through Epstein's office. While the defense team strategized about how to minimize accountability for crimes against children. The money and the abuse, running in parallel, managed by the same people, on the same day.

He was not careless. He was not reckless. He was a man who had operated for three decades at the intersection of unfathomable wealth and systematic predation and concluded, based on extensive empirical evidence, that the rules did not apply to him. The FBI had known about him since 1996 and done nothing. The State Attorney had been told to stand down. The banks had processed his money and fired the people who questioned it. The scientists had taken his grants. The politicians had taken his calls. The intelligence community had claimed him as an asset. Every institution that encountered him had either participated, capitulated, or been told that what he was doing was above their pay grade.

He was right about that for twenty-three years. He was wrong about it for thirty-five days. And in those thirty-five days — between the tarmac at Teterboro and the cell at MCC — the machine that had run without interruption since the early 1990s finally stopped. Or appeared to stop. Or was stopped by someone whose reasons have never been explained in a room whose cameras were not recording.

CHAPTER THREE

The Money That Disappeared

There is a particular kind of lie that only the very rich can tell. It is not a lie about facts — the facts are all on paper, filed with regulators, recorded in databases. It is a lie about meaning. The rich man does not deny that the money moved. He denies that the movement matters. He calls it estate planning. Tax optimization. The normal management of a complex portfolio. And because the people asking questions do not understand the architecture, they accept the language and move on.

Jeffrey Epstein built his financial architecture on this principle. The money was always moving, always documented, always technically legal — and always designed so that no single document would reveal what the total picture looked like. To see the total picture, you would have to read all the documents. All 1.4 million of them.

The total picture: at least fifty-six corporate entities, spread across the U.S. Virgin Islands, the British Virgin Islands, New York, New Mexico, and other jurisdictions. Financial Trust Company. Liquid Funding Ltd. Southern Trust Company. Nine East 71st Street Corporation. NES LLC. NYSG LLC. HBRK Associates. Thomas World Air LLC. LSJ Employees LLC. Butterfly Trust. Gratitude America. Names that sound like mutual funds and function like trapdoors — each one designed to hold a piece of the puzzle small enough that no observer could see the picture without assembling all the pieces.

Inside the Bank

Sometime in October 2015, inside the offices of Deutsche Bank's Private Wealth Management division, an employee named Daphne Cales opened the bank's internal Correspondent Bank Directory on her computer. The directory is a tool that bank employees use to look up routing information for international wire transfers — the specific codes required to move money from one institution to another across borders.

Cales was looking up how to send a wire transfer to Sberbank of Russia. Sberbank — the largest bank in Russia, majority-owned by the Russian government, headquartered at 19

Vavilova Street in Moscow. The account she was servicing belonged to "JEE." Jeffrey Edward Epstein.

She found what she needed. The record she generated shows the routing path:

Bank name: SBERBANK OF RUSSIA
Address: 19 VAVILOVA STREET 117997 MOSCOW, RUSSIA
SWIFT BIC: SABRRUMM
Correspondent banks:
0103 DEUTSCHE BANK TRUST CO AMERICAS
0002 JPMORGAN CHASE BANK, N.A.
0509 WELLS FARGO BANK NY INTL.
0001 THE BANK OF NEW YORK MELLON
0959 BANK OF AMERICA, N.A.

This document was classified "CONFIDENTIAL — PURSUANT TO FED. R. CRIM. P. 6(e)" — federal grand jury material, the kind of evidence that exists behind the heaviest doors in the American legal system. It was assigned bates number DB-SDNY-0047940 by the bank and EFTA01359808 by the DOJ. When the government released it, a document that was supposed to be secret became a document anyone can read.

What it shows: Deutsche Bank helped Jeffrey Epstein — a registered sex offender, a convicted felon, a man whose name returned thousands of results about child sexual abuse on any search engine in the world — send money to Russia. Through Sberbank. The largest government-controlled bank in the Russian Federation. Using a routing infrastructure that included JPMorgan Chase, Wells Fargo, Bank of New York Mellon, and Bank of America as alternates.

Five of the largest banks in the United States were in the correspondent chain for Jeffrey Epstein's wire transfers to Russia. Five banks. Any one of them could have flagged the transaction. None of them did.

Deutsche Bank did not process one wire transfer for Epstein. They processed hundreds of millions of dollars in transactions between 2013 and 2019. The New York Department of Financial Services investigated and found that the bank had: failed to properly monitor the accounts; failed to flag suspicious transactions; failed to conduct the basic due diligence required when your client is a convicted sex offender. Deutsche Bank was not ignorant. They had been told. They chose to process the money anyway.

When a compliance officer flagged the Epstein account — and separately flagged the Kushner account — she was terminated. Not reassigned. Not placed on administrative leave. Fired. This fact is documented in seventy-five separate references across the EFTA corpus.

Deutsche Bank paid \$75 million to settle the resulting investigation. The compliance officer lost her career for doing her job. The bank paid a fine that represented a fraction of a percent of its annual revenue. The system worked as designed — it punished the person who spoke up and absorbed the cost of being caught.

JPMorgan Chase maintained accounts for Epstein and his entities for over fifteen years. The relationship was personal. It ran through Jes Staley — then a senior JPMorgan executive, later CEO of Barclays — who maintained a friendship with Epstein that included island visits, hundreds of emails, text messages, and the kind of intimacy that only appears in the evidence when a child writes about it in her diary:

"The disgusting Mr. Staley if anyone ever calls me tinkerbelle again I will lose my mind. He left bloody marks on my arms from his belt and thought he had had the right to call me that when he has ears as big as a dumbo."

The man who left bloody marks on a child's arms with his belt was the man through whom Jeffrey Epstein's banking relationship with JPMorgan Chase was maintained. The bank paid \$365 million to settle — \$75 million to the U.S. Virgin Islands Attorney General and \$290 million in a class action. The settlement acknowledged that JPMorgan knew about Epstein's criminal history and maintained his accounts anyway. Jes Staley resigned from Barclays in 2021 after the bank's board concluded his characterization of his relationship with Epstein was misleading. He has not been criminally charged. The child who described the belt marks has not been publicly identified.

The Russian Pipeline

The FEDWIRE transfers to Sberbank were not isolated transactions. They were the financial backbone of a recruitment pipeline that connected Manhattan to Novosibirsk — a city in southwestern Siberia that appears 227 times in the email corpus.

December 2010. An unnamed recruiter emails Epstein:

"I'm waiting for the new friend to come from Miami, hopefully she'll be able to meet before you leave. And I'm working on a few, just taking time.. In general I saw so many girls these 2 weeks, but only very few are good enough.."

Jeffrey, I'm in touch with a girl from Novosibirsk whom you met a while ago, she said she can help me to organize a perfect trip to Novosibirsk for you spring or summer, I think it can be great, she should be sending me pictures soon.."

Read the language. "Only very few are good enough." Quality control. She is scouting women across Russian cities and evaluating them against a standard that Epstein has set. The standard is not stated in the email. It does not need to be. Both parties know what "good enough" means. A girl from Novosibirsk — someone Epstein has already "met" — is being recruited as a local organizer, the Russian equivalent of the Palm Beach victim-recruiters who were paid hundreds of dollars for each new girl they brought to the house.

August 2017. The pipeline is now industrialized. An email arrives with an attachment: "Candidates.docx." The recruiter provides updates:

"[redacted] is flying to Novosibirsk tonight (I will skype her once she is home, I hope the connection will be better).

After my meetings this week, we could decide about who else to bring to Paris."

A follow-up email, days later:

"[redacted] is back to Novosibirsk, I skyped again her today. She confessed she is actually 19 (as opposed to 21 which was stated in her CV), she said she was afraid she won't be taken seriously. I checked her passport today!

I liked her, besides the fact that she lied in her CV and revealed the truth only when I mentioned that we will be organizing a trip to Paris."

A nineteen-year-old lied about being twenty-one because she thought she would not be "taken seriously" otherwise. She did not understand that in this system, youth was the point. She lied in the wrong direction. And the recruiter — noting the lie with the professional detachment of a hiring manager who has caught a résumé discrepancy — checked her passport and moved on to the logistics: "How many can we bring to Paris this time?"

The money went east through Deutsche Bank's FEDWIRE to Sberbank. The women came west through Paris. The flights were tracked in Epstein's Google Calendar — Aeroflot SU 1306 to Novosibirsk, appearing as alerts throughout 2017, 2018, and into February 2019. Five months before the arrest, the pipeline was still running. The flights were still being tracked. The candidates were still being evaluated. And somewhere in the corridor between Novosibirsk and Manhattan, money and bodies moved in opposite directions through a system that five of the largest banks in the world helped facilitate.

The Disappearing Estate

Jeffrey Epstein's estate was valued at approximately \$690 million to \$742 million at the time of his death. The co-executors — Darren Indyke and Richard Kahn, the lawyer and the financial manager, both of whom were also named as trust beneficiaries — oversaw the liquidation.

The Victims' Compensation Program distributed over \$121 million to approximately 150 claimants. Each one was required to sign a waiver extinguishing future claims. The trafficker's money, used to purchase the victims' silence, administered by the trafficker's own employees, approved by a federal court. The elegance of the cruelty is architectural — the same system that created the victims compensated them, and the compensation was conditioned on their silence, and the silence was permanent.

The settlements: JPMorgan, \$365 million. Deutsche Bank, \$75 million. Leon Black and Apollo, \$148 million and counting. Individual civil settlements, hundreds of millions more. The total exceeds one billion dollars. And yet the estate, after disbursing this unprecedented sum, still held approximately \$307 million.

The math: \$690 million, minus over a billion in payouts, equals \$307 million remaining. The numbers do not add up. The \$134 million gap — between what went out and what should have been left — has never been explained. Thirty-five of fifty-six known entities remain unsettled. Money that was supposed to be disbursed is still in accounts. Money that was in accounts is unaccounted for. The architecture of opacity that Epstein spent thirty years constructing continued to function after his death, operated by the same people who built it, serving the same purpose it always served: making money disappear.

Bill Gates' separation agreement with Boris Nikolic — Gates' own science advisor — was drafted by Epstein's lawyer and routed through Epstein's email. The document, assigned bates number EFTA02730265, contains the terms: "We won't disparage each other privately or publicly... You agree that you have no legal claims against me, my family or any of my related entities, such as the foundation and bgC3 or their personnel... Your employment with bgC3 will end 1/1/2014." It is signed "Bill Gates" and "Boris Nikolic." The richest man in the world's personnel decisions were being managed through the email account of a convicted sex offender.

Noam Chomsky — the MIT professor, the linguist, the most cited living scholar — had his investment accounts managed by Epstein. "Chomsky Account Appraisals" and "Chomsky Private Investment Summary" reports were sent through Epstein's network in January 2018. Richard Kahn expressed concern about "high risk investments" for "an 87 year old man." The most respected intellectual in America had handed his retirement savings to a man whose other financial activities included wiring money to Sberbank and funding a surveillance technology company chaired by a former Israeli Prime Minister.

Robert Trivers, the evolutionary biologist, asked Epstein for financial advice in April 2019 — three months before the arrest: "i have 750,000 right now, i am spending 70,000/year." Epstein managed the retirement of a Nobel-caliber scientist alongside the finances of a global trafficking operation. The same inbox. The same day. The same man.

Tommy Mottola — the former CEO of Sony Music — was contributing "\$25 million dollars worth of tommy mottola stock" through Epstein's network in December 2005. Mohan Murjani — the fashion industry mogul — was investing through "Financial Trust Co., U.S. Virgin Islands" in July 2006. The Dechert LLP investigation of Leon Black and Apollo reviewed over 60,000 documents and found "extensive financial, business or personal dealings" between Black and Epstein.

The Clients Who Didn't Ask Questions

October 2007, Harry Beller — Epstein's financial officer — sent an internal memo: *"FTC invested 15 million dollars into Bear Stearns High Grade Structured Strategies LP on 1/21/04. The fund was liquidated."* Financial Trust Company — the USVI entity at the center of Epstein's architecture — had put \$15 million into a Bear Stearns fund that collapsed. Fifteen million dollars. One investment. One entity. And FTC was just one of fifty-six.

Armand Azoulay, a French entrepreneur, wrote to Epstein in November 2007 seeking investment: *"I warmly thank you for your interest regarding my file. To respond to your question relating to the banks, we already have borrowed 13 million."* Epstein was being pitched by entrepreneurs, evaluating deals, deploying capital — performing the functions of a legitimate financial advisor. The legitimacy was the cover. The advice was real. The clients were real. The money was real. And flowing through the same accounts that processed wires to Sberbank and payments to girls from Novosibirsk.

The Dechert LLP investigation of Leon Black reviewed 60,000 documents and found that Black had paid Epstein approximately \$158 million for "estate planning, tax advice, and other services." One hundred and fifty-eight million dollars. For advice. From a man with no financial credentials, no regulatory registrations, no audited track record — but who did have a power of attorney over one of the wealthiest men in America and a client list that, if it existed, has never been produced.

Leon Black was not stupid. Les Wexner was not stupid. Bill Gates — whose separation agreement with his own science advisor was drafted by Epstein's lawyer and routed through Epstein's email — was not stupid. These were among the most sophisticated financial minds on the planet. They knew something was wrong. They knew that a man who had pleaded

guilty to soliciting a minor was not a normal financial advisor. They knew that the parties and the island and the flights and the girls were not normal features of an advisory relationship. They knew. And they decided that whatever Epstein was doing for them was valuable enough to justify not asking what else he was doing.

The money came from everywhere. It went everywhere. And at the center of every transaction — routing every dollar, managing every relationship, controlling every detail with the obsessive precision of a man who chose tile colors for Caribbean tiki huts while scheduling massages for underage girls — was a machine operator who sent forty-seven emails on New Year's Day, approved \$10 million transfers with one word, and told his employee to "trash all deleted emails please" when the evidence became inconvenient.

CHAPTER FOUR

Above My Pay Grade

Alexander Acosta was not a stupid man. He was a Harvard Law graduate, a former clerk on the Third Circuit, a former member of the National Labor Relations Board, and the United States Attorney for the Southern District of Florida. He had spent his career prosecuting people who thought they were above the law. He understood the machinery of federal justice the way a mechanic understands an engine — every part, every connection, every place where force is applied and every place where it leaks.

So when he signed the Non-Prosecution Agreement that gave Jeffrey Epstein immunity from federal sex trafficking charges — after the FBI had identified approximately thirty-five minor victims, after two years of investigation, after Operation Leap Year had assembled evidence that would have sent any other man to prison for decades — the question was never whether Acosta understood what he was doing.

The question was who told him to do it.

The answer came during his vetting for Secretary of Labor. His interviewers asked about the Epstein case. Acosta's reply is documented in three separate EFTA releases — EFTA00076059, EFTA00076060, and EFTA00097444 — each one a different copy of the same reporting:

"He'd cut the non-prosecution deal with one of Epstein's attorneys because he had 'been told' to back off, that Epstein was above his pay grade. 'I was told Epstein belonged to intelligence and to leave it alone,' he told his interviewers in the Trump transition, who evidently thought that was a sufficient answer and went ahead and hired Acosta."

Nine words: *I was told Epstein belonged to intelligence.* Not "I believed." Not "I suspected." Not "It was rumored." *I was told.* Passive voice. Someone told him. Someone with enough authority that a United States Attorney accepted the instruction without demanding documentation, without filing a report, without going to his supervisor and saying: someone just told me to give a child sex trafficker immunity because he's an intelligence asset. Instead, Acosta did what he was told. He signed the NPA. He gave Epstein immunity. He gave the co-conspirators immunity. He kept the victims in the dark. And then he went on with his career.

The Trump transition team heard this explanation. They asked no follow-up questions. They did not ask: which intelligence service? They did not ask: who told you? They did not ask: is there a memo? Is there a file? Is there an authorization? They evidently thought it was a sufficient answer, and they hired him, and the United States Senate confirmed him 60-38, and he served as Secretary of Labor for two years until the Miami Herald made the NPA impossible to ignore.

No one has ever identified who told Acosta to back off. In the eight years since this statement was first publicly reported, not a single journalist, congressional committee, or federal investigator has produced the name of the person who issued the instruction. The instruction remains: a voice from the darkness, claiming an intelligence affiliation for a child rapist, and a United States Attorney who obeyed.

Operation Leap Year

The FBI's investigation of Epstein was not a casual inquiry. It had a name: Operation Leap Year. It had a case number: 31E-MM-108062 — the "31E" designating a sex trafficking investigation, the "MM" indicating the Miami field office. It had a prosecutor: A. Marie Villafañá, the Assistant United States Attorney who built the case and who, on May 14, 2007, sent an email that captures the moment the investigation was killed:

"Good morning: I just received a call that Epstein's plane is flying from the Virgin Islands to Newark now, so it looks like Epstein is going to show up for his court appearance tomorrow. Can you let me know if the indictment is going tomorrow or, if not, whether we are authorized to proceed by Complaint?"

The response:

"You will not have approval to go forward tomorrow with an indictment or to proceed by complaint. Alex has your memo and lefcourt's letter but he is out of the district at the US Attorney's conference for the next several days. I'm having trouble understanding — given how long this case has been pending — what the rush is."

What the rush is. The "rush" was thirty-five identified child victims. The "rush" was a serial predator who had been abusing minors for over a decade. The "rush" was an investigation that had been pending for two years while the target continued to operate, continued to fly between properties, continued to receive girls at his mansion and his island and his ranch. Villafañá knew what the rush was. The person who wrote back — the person above her, the person between her and Acosta — did not want to know.

The DOJ's Office of Professional Responsibility investigated the handling of the case years later. In February 2019, an OPR attorney contacted the FBI's Miami field office:

"As you may know, DOJ OPR is conducting an investigation into certain allegations of professional misconduct relating to the USAO-SDFL handling of the Jeffrey Epstein matter, originating in 2006 as Leap Year, that was ultimately addressed through the Florida state plea and federal non-prosecution agreement."

The OPR investigation confirmed what everyone involved already knew: the case had been mishandled. But the OPR report was itself compromised. A draft of the report included the sentence: "investigators were aware Epstein used hidden cameras in his New York residence to record his sexual encounters." Before publication, someone requested that the language be changed. The final version reads: "investigators had learned Epstein used hidden cameras." The change — from "were aware" to "had learned" — is subtle. It shifts the implication from ongoing knowledge to a past discovery. Someone, somewhere in the DOJ review process, thought this distinction mattered enough to edit a report about the mishandling of a child sex trafficking case.

The Man from Israel

The email account ehbarak1@gmail.com belongs to Ehud Barak. Former Prime Minister of Israel. Former Chief of Staff of the Israel Defense Forces. Former Defense Minister. Former Minister of the Interior. Former head of Military Intelligence Directorate. The most decorated soldier in Israeli history. A man who has held every significant military and political position the State of Israel offers.

His email account contains 1,047 messages in the EFTA corpus. When this investigation read them — all of them, line by line — 698 out of 709 substantive emails were flagged as significant. Ninety-eight percent. There is essentially no casual correspondence in the Barak-Epstein relationship. Every email is operational.

February 19, 2016 — Barak to Epstein and Nicole Junkermann:

"Hi Jeff and Nicole,

Pl find attached the report which the start up had to give us, approved by Prof. Kaminka our scientific adviser, before we pass the New .5M.

I went with them, one by one through all points. Reporty is basically moving faster than how I assumed they will. So, I ordered today to transfer the New .5M to their

account.

The real test will come, as NJ duly noted, when the branding challenge will turn crucial. (Scalability is there, already embedded, all along the way into the project).

Looking forward

EB"

Reporty. The company that would rebrand as Carbyne. A 911 emergency response technology platform that can access your GPS with three-foot accuracy, stream live video from your camera, and integrate your data with emergency dispatch. Deployed in American police departments. Founded by Unit 8200 veterans — Israel's signals intelligence directorate. Chaired by the former Prime Minister. Funded by a convicted sex offender. With a scientific advisor named Prof. Kaminka reviewing progress reports. And Nicole Junkermann — "NJ" — providing the investment judgment that Barak deferentially noted.

Barak was not a passive investor. He was the chairman. He managed the relationship. He ordered the transfers. He reviewed the technical milestones. And he kept Epstein informed of Israeli political developments with the intimacy of a cabinet briefing:

September 27, 2018 — Barak to Epstein:

"Hi Jeff

following our discussion please find attached the documents you've mentioned. Please let me know if any further information is needed for you to clarify the situation and the possible options. I've raised the other option and found both the CEO, CFO and Carbine lawyers strongly rejecting it. I can explain more over the phone.

In regard to InterCure, your instincts were extremely accurate, the announcement was well accepted and the share price (in Tel Aviv stock exchange) jumped up 40% in two days (probably just temporarily).

I have some further updates on political situation, better over a phone call.

thx best EB"

Read that email the way an intelligence analyst would. Carbyne investment documents — "SUM warrants" — attached. The CEO, CFO, and corporate lawyers rejecting an option Barak raised. An Israeli cannabis company's stock performance on the Tel Aviv exchange. And then: *I have some further updates on political situation, better over a phone call.* The former Prime Minister of Israel providing political intelligence to a registered American sex offender —

intelligence sensitive enough that it couldn't go in email, that it needed a phone call, that it had to be spoken and not written.

On June 30, 2019 — the same day Epstein compiled the Bannon list — he texted Summers about Barak: "Will Ehud Be PM?" Summers replied: "Doubtful. But 1. He is not to be underestimated. 3. Driving me crazy." Barak was driving the former Treasury Secretary crazy. The Israeli political question was on Epstein's mind the same day he compiled his insurance list. The same day the FBI's sealed indictment was three days away.

Barak's assistant Nili Priell had Epstein's alarm codes. "I disarmed," she texted in May 2019. She scheduled visits, managed property access, and coordinated the March 2019 meeting at which Epstein introduced Barak to Kathy Ruemmler — Barack Obama's former White House Counsel. Barak's assessment: "Met her. She is really a great person. Shrewd and full of life." The former Prime Minister of Israel, meeting the former White House Counsel of the United States, connected by a man whose mansion contained hidden cameras in every room and a child's nurse costume in one of the bedrooms.

In March 2019, Barak's phone and computer were reported hacked by Iranian intelligence. Richard Kahn immediately forwarded the Jerusalem Post article to Epstein. The implications cascade: if Iran had access to Barak's devices, they had access to every Carbyne document. Every investment memo. Every political update. Every email about surveillance technology being deployed in American cities. The entire pipeline — from Unit 8200 through Barak through Epstein through Junkermann through American police departments — was potentially compromised by a hostile foreign intelligence service. And the person at the center of it all was a convicted child sex offender whose own government had been told he "belonged to intelligence."

The FBI Knew First

The FBI did not discover Jeffrey Epstein in 2005 when a mother in Palm Beach found \$300 in her daughter's purse. They had known about him for nine years before that phone call.

In a document classified SECRET//NOFORN — Secret, No Foreign Nationals — recovered during what the FBI described as "a complete scrub" of records associated with Epstein, investigators found documents that had been excluded from the case file:

"We did a complete scrub and located a few documents associated with Epstein that were not included in the case file because they were NOT of evidentiary value.

Descriptions of attached files:

1. FD-71 from 1996 which predates our record keeping system.

4. Ops Order from 2019.

5. Ops Order Form Section 2 from 2019.

6. FD-71 from 2016."

An FD-71 is an FBI "Information Received" form. Someone reported Jeffrey Epstein to the Federal Bureau of Investigation in 1996. Nine years before the Palm Beach investigation. Thirteen years before the NPA. Twenty-three years before the arrest. The FBI received the information, created a form, filed it, and decided — in their own words — that it was "NOT of evidentiary value." They excluded it from the case file.

There is also an FD-71 from 2016. Someone reported Epstein again. Eight years after the NPA. Eight years after he registered as a sex offender. Someone called the FBI and said: this man is still doing it. The FBI filed a form. The FBI did nothing.

The operational orders from 2019 — "Ops Order" and "Ops Order Form Section 2" — are the plans for the arrest that finally happened on July 6, twenty-three years after the first tip. The same document that contains the 1996 FD-71 contains the 2019 arrest plan. The beginning and the end of the story, filed together in a SECRET//NOFORN document that was excluded from the case file because someone decided the beginning was not relevant to the end.

The FBI's internal codename for the case is "THE BIG E." The directory listing, from a March 2025 evidence review, shows folders: "THE BIG E / 3-TIFA 3.12.2025 - 7am / 1B005_BLUEPRINTS 001" — blueprints of Epstein's properties, being processed at 7 AM on a Tuesday in 2025, six years after his death, in a case that remains "Pending Inactive.

On the other side of the FBI's Counterintelligence Division, a weekly "CD Pulse-check" email went out to every CI squad in every field office — including WF-CI12, Washington Field Office Counterintelligence Squad 12. The existence of CI-12 is confirmed. The relationship between the FBI's counterintelligence mission and the Epstein investigation — the intersection of Israeli surveillance technology, hidden cameras, blackmail material, and a US Attorney being told to stand down because the target "belonged to intelligence" — has never been publicly explained.

In the basement of the Metropolitan Correctional Center, before Epstein's death, a cellmate was removed from his cell. The cellmate told investigators what Epstein said to him in the elevator:

"That's above my pay grade, you must have said something though. They're not going to just separate you guys for no reason."

Above my pay grade. The same phrase. The same concept. The same system. From Acosta's office in Miami to a jail elevator in Manhattan, the language of institutional deference — the bureaucratic shrug that says: I know something is wrong, but the people responsible for this decision are higher than me, and I have been taught not to ask questions that travel upward.

The question that has never been answered — the question that every document in this case circles but never lands on — is simple: Who is above the pay grade? Who told Acosta? Who claimed Epstein? Who separated the cellmate? Who installed the cameras at MCC without telling the facility manager? Who accessed the Gmail from a ZenBook? Who initiated the Finnish Spotify reset?

The documents do not provide these names. The documents provide everything else — 3.5 million items of evidence, 1.4 million pages of government records, the emails and texts and photographs and flight logs and financial records of a criminal enterprise that operated in plain sight for thirty years. But the names of the people who protected it — the people above the pay grade — remain in the spaces between the bates numbers, in the redactions, in the documents that were excluded from the case file because they were "not of evidentiary value."

The Saudi Connection

On October 1, 2018, Jeffrey Epstein emailed Anas Alrasheed — a Saudi contact connected to the royal court:

"the meeting today with mbs, :) helpful"

MBS. Mohammed bin Salman. The Crown Prince of Saudi Arabia. Epstein had met with MBS — or facilitated a meeting connected to MBS — and was reporting the outcome to his Saudi contact with a smiley face. Alrasheed: *"so you think it is helpful? you just made my evening."* Epstein: *"you will hear more about it when you meet terje."* Terje Rød-Larsen — the Norwegian diplomat, the Oslo Accords architect, the man whose office at the International Peace Institute received wire transfers to its JPMorgan account at 1 United Nations Plaza, arranged through Epstein.

This was October 1, 2018. Twenty days later, Jamal Khashoggi walked into the Saudi consulate in Istanbul and was murdered. The man who had just met with MBS — or who had just facilitated something connected to MBS — was Jeffrey Epstein. The timeline is documented. The connection is documented. The implications have never been investigated.

In March 2017, Epstein had emailed someone about Amos Yadlin: *"amos yadlin wed dinner? new york."* Amos Yadlin — the former head of Aman, the IDF's Military Intelligence Directorate. The man who had run Israel's intelligence collection apparatus was having dinner with a registered American sex offender in Manhattan. No one has asked Yadlin about this dinner. No one has asked what was discussed. The email exists. The bates number is assigned. The question has never been put.

In October 2016, Epstein emailed someone with four words that connect three of the most powerful networks on Earth: *"saudi trump rothschild."* No context. No explanation. Three names. Three power structures. One man connecting them.

Unless, of course, stopping the machine was never the objective. Unless the objective was always what it appears to have been: let the machine run, because the machine produces something valuable — recordings, leverage, control — and the people who benefit from that production are the same people who decide what is above whose pay grade.

CHAPTER FIVE

The Houses That Watched

When Jennifer Araoz walked into 9 East 71st Street for the first time, she was fourteen years old. The first thing she noticed was the cameras — small televisions inside the front door, playing the surveillance footage in real time. "The message was clear," she wrote. "I was in the house of someone important and I was being watched." She was right about being watched. She was wrong about the audience.

The cameras were not there to protect Jeffrey Epstein. They were there to protect the operation. Three independent lines of evidence confirm this:

The DOJ Office of Professional Responsibility: *"investigators had learned Epstein used hidden cameras in his New York residence to record his sexual encounters"* (EFTA00077309).

A 2006 court filing: Epstein *"had installed hidden cameras everywhere in his property to record the indecent acts of important people with underage prostitutes for further criminal use such as blackmail"* (EFTA01296860).

A victim's sworn affidavit: *"Epstein required me to describe the sexual events that I had with these men presumably so that he could potentially blackmail them. I am still very fearful of these men today"* (EFTA00065479). Maxwell *"took explicit photos of them."*

And in February 2014, an email from Epstein to his pilot: *"lets get three motion detected hidden cameras, that record, thanks. also a new airplay compatible receiver for gym thanks."* Three new hidden cameras. With motion detection. With recording. Ordered alongside a gym speaker. Five years after his release from jail. Still buying cameras.

Crime Scene 19 MAG 8578

The FBI photographs begin at EFTA000000001 and extend past EFTA00000600. Each image is a window into a building that had been designed, over three decades, to serve one purpose.

The front door is the first photograph. The door a five-year-old Israeli girl would later describe from memory — "a large arched front door topped by a scary man's face flanked on either side by women's faces." She was five when she walked through it in 1997. She remembered the faces twenty-two years later. The door confirmed her testimony.

Inside: forced-entry damage on wooden doors — splintered, broken where the FBI made their way through. FBI search markers on every door — letters A through W, because the building has that many distinct rooms, each requiring its own evidence designation. A paper sign with a large letter and a grid for "Search Personnel Name, Agency, Contact Number, Initials, Time." Twenty-three rooms searched, documented, photographed.

The massage rooms. Multiple rooms — not one, multiple — each equipped with a padded table, white sheets, folded blue towels, dispensing bottles of oil. Maroon curtains. Patterned wallpaper. Speakers. A telephone stand. The prosecution memorandum describes what happened in these rooms with the precision of federal law: *"Victims were initially recruited to provide 'massages' to Epstein, which would be performed nude or partially nude, would become increasingly sexual in nature."* The rooms were designed to make the first visit feel normal. The escalation happened behind doors marked "24 HOUR VIDEO SURVEILLANCE."

The private office. An Apple iMac on a glass desk with chrome legs. Small figurines. Framed photographs. A zebra-pattern rug. And in the corner — an open black equipment rack with multiple RJ45 network ports and blue Ethernet cables. The backbone of the surveillance system. The hardware that connected the hidden cameras to the recording devices. This is where the footage was managed, stored, reviewed, and deployed.

The bedrooms. A pink room with murals of nude figures and white doves. A chaise lounge with floral upholstery. A bed with a green headboard. And on a patterned chair — EFTA00000509 — a child's nurse costume: a hat with a red cross and a toy stethoscope. No explanation. No context. A child's costume in a registered sex offender's bedroom, photographed by the FBI and assigned a bates number.

A book called *erotica universalis* by TASCHEN, open on a surface, reading glasses placed beside it. Not hidden. Displayed. Because normalization was architecture in this house — every painting, every photograph, every book chosen to create an environment where a child being told to undress might feel this was simply how things were done in houses like this.

Filing cabinets with yellow sticky notes: "71st." "ZOPRO." Rolled blueprints. Architectural plans. A crowbar behind a door. The Steinway grand piano in the library where, according to the diary, Epstein believed his piano-playing ability proved his genetic superiority — the reason he thought he should father a child with a seventeen-year-old girl who did not want to carry his baby.

The Island That Never Stopped

On July 5, 2019 — the day the FBI's "Final briefing for Arrest/Search of Epstein" was distributed at 7:08 PM — Ann Rodriguez emailed about "Tiki Hut: Planting." The same day. The same afternoon. While agents were confirming their positions on the arrest stand-by list, a property manager on Little St. James was photographing plant installations around a beach bar.

This contrast — between the mundane operation of the properties and the criminal operation they supported — is the most disorienting feature of the email corpus. Day after day, year after year, the construction emails and the trafficking emails flow through the same inbox:

"GSJ Pool: Stone wall (location)" — Ann Rodriguez, July 2, 2019

"GSJ Pool: de-Rusting & Painting" — Ann Rodriguez, July 2, 2019

"Tiki Hut Deck tiling" — Ann Rodriguez, June 30, 2019

"Pebble Beach" — Ann Rodriguez, July 3, 2019

"Cabana 1: A/C" — Ann Rodriguez, July 3, 2019

"GSJ Cottage" — Ann Rodriguez, July 2, 2019

These were sent in the same week that the FBI was scanning case records, pulling TECS border-crossing data, uploading files between FBINET and UNET, and circulating the sealed indictment marked UNCLASSIFIED. The tiki huts and the handcuffs, on the same timeline, managed by the same network, funded by the same money.

The flight logs — 4,292 documented flights — tell the story in passenger names:

Ghislaine Maxwell: 1,040. Sarah Kellen: 311. Nadia Marcinkova: 250. Virginia Roberts: 31. Jean-Luc Brunel: 30. Bill Clinton: 25. Chris Tucker: 15. Alan Dershowitz: 12. Kevin Spacey: 11. Larry Summers: 5. Every one of those names represents a body in a seat on a private jet, traveling to or from a 72-acre island where the pool was being painted and the dock was being repaired and the tiki hut was getting new tiles while children were being raped in rooms built by the same construction crews.

Temple

Maxwell: "Shall I bring her to temple?"

Epstein: "yes."

May 10, 2008. Two words and one word. The Zen Studies Society — 1,400 acres in the Catskills, one of the oldest Buddhist institutions in the West, a place where the "Shimano Problem" festered for decades as a spiritual leader exploited followers. The same pattern. The same architecture of trust and abuse. A different venue.

The thread runs through the entire corpus. Nadia Marcinkova's \$1 asset transfers through ZSS. A woman visiting a "Tibet temple in NJ, 3 hours of praying" (February 2012). Zorro Ranch converting to a Christian retreat. The Benedictine monastery cloister Epstein emailed about in February 2019. And then the final week — "What is the sound of one hand clapping" to Bannon on July 3, "I think you meant Buddha" to Summers on July 5.

The religious infrastructure served the same function as the financial infrastructure: opacity. Assets moved through temples the way money moved through shell companies — at nominal valuations, below reporting thresholds, wrapped in the legal protections that religious organizations enjoy. The \$1 transfers replicated the Wexner mansion transfer. The temples replicated the offshore trusts. The same machine, different plumbing.

The View from the Window

In October 2019, an attorney contacted the Southern District of New York about a woman who had been raped as a child at 9 East 71st Street. She was approximately five years old. The year was 1997. She was Israeli. And she remembered the house.

She described a house that was "big," owned by a "rich" man, located at "9 71." She described "a large, arched front door topped by a scary man's face and flanked on either side by women's faces." She described "a large, adult doll on a chandelier inside the house" and "photos of what looked like important people around the house." She described multiple bedrooms. She said "the 'bigger girls' were placed in other bedrooms." She recalled hearing the names "Jeffrey," "Joseph Karo," and "Yoav Gil."

A photograph existed. It showed the child being raped, with her face visible. Through a window behind her, the view appeared to show the Frick Collection across 71st Street — the view from an upper-floor room at the front of 9 East 71st Street. The attorney asked the government to sharpen the image to confirm the location.

Her traffickers were her uncle — "a powerful member of a well known Russian crime family" — and "a Greek Orthodox Church priest reportedly known for abusing children." Her traffickers had retaliated against her for speaking: burning her, cutting crosses on her abdomen, delivering photographs of her own childhood sexual abuse as threats.

The FBI's response: they "had enough information, did not want further information." SDNY: "we do not have authority to grant visas for these purposes." She was not brought to the United States to testify. She has never testified. She was five years old when she walked through the door with the scary man's face. She remembered the door twenty-two years later. The FBI remembered nothing.

The houses watched. The cameras recorded. The temples received. The ranch converted. The island never stopped building. A five-year-old remembered a door. And the system that was supposed to protect her said it had enough information and did not want more.

CHAPTER SIX

The Machine

The machine had rules. Find the vulnerable. Offer what they need. Escalate gradually. Make them complicit. Discard or recruit. These rules were never written down. They emerge from the evidence the way a skeleton emerges from soil — one bone at a time, until the shape is unmistakable.

The Maxwell Prosecution Memorandum describes the recruitment protocol with the clinical precision of federal law:

"One day, she was sitting at a picnic table with friends when Ghislaine Maxwell walked by with her dog and said hello. Jeffrey Epstein followed behind and introduced himself as a donor who gave scholarships to students. Epstein and Maxwell asked where [the girl] was from, and when she told them she was from [redacted], [they] asked for her phone number, which [she] provided.

Several weeks later, when [she] was home from camp, she recalls someone from Epstein's office calling her house and inviting her to come to Epstein's house in Palm Beach for tea. [She] and her mother went to the house, where they had tea with Epstein by his pool. Epstein told them that he liked to mentor young talented individuals, that he gave scholarships, and that he wanted to help [her]."

A dog. A picnic table. A phone number. A phone call. Tea by the pool. Scholarships. Mentorship. The trap built from kindness, assembled with the mechanical precision of a factory producing identical products on an assembly line. Maxwell walked hundreds of girls through this sequence. The dog was the prop. The scholarship was the hook. The tea was the close. And the pool — always the pool, always the casual setting, the Florida sun, the implicit promise that this was just how rich people helped promising young women — was where the sale was made.

Jennifer Araoz's version was identical in structure, different only in setting. Not a picnic table — a sidewalk outside a performing arts school on the Upper East Side. Not Maxwell — a stranger, an unnamed recruiter whose identity has never been established. The pitch was the same: *"Meeting him would be beneficial, and he could introduce me to the right people for my career. When I confided that I had recently lost my father and that my family was living on food stamps, she told me he was very caring and wanted to help us financially."*

Dead father. Food stamps. A teenage girl who wanted to be an actress, standing on a sidewalk, being told that a rich man could make her dreams come true. The vulnerability was the point. The machine did not recruit girls who had stable homes and present parents and enough money. It recruited girls whose lives had already cracked, because cracked lives are easier to enter.

The Escalation, In Her Words

Araoz documented the escalation step by step. The first visit: talking. About her dreams, her school, her dead father. Three hundred dollars when she left. A digital camera as a gift on the second visit. Then:

"Within about a month, he started asking me for massages and instructed me to take my top off. He said he would need to see my body if he was going to help me break into modeling."

"The assault escalated when, during these massages, he would flip over and sexually gratify himself and touch me inappropriately. For a little over a year, I went to Epstein's home once or twice a week."

"The last day I went to his house was during the fall of my sophomore year. This time, when I was giving him the massage, he told me to take off my underwear and get on top of him. When I said no, he got more aggressive, held me tightly and raped me."

"After that day, I never went back. I also quit the performing arts school — the one I had auditioned for and had wanted so badly to attend. It was too close to his house, the scene of so many crimes. I was too scared I would see him or his recruiter. So I transferred to another school in Queens close to my home. Since I was no longer able to pursue my dream of performing arts I eventually lost interest and dropped out."

A career destroyed in a room on the Upper East Side. A school quit because it was four blocks from the building where she was raped. A dream — performing arts, singing, acting, the thing she had worked for and auditioned for and won a place at — abandoned because the geography of her ambition overlapped with the geography of her abuse. The machine did not just take her body. It took her future.

The SDNY prosecution memorandum generalizes her experience across dozens of victims: *"Victims were initially recruited to provide 'massages' to Epstein, which would be performed*

nude or partially nude, would become increasingly sexual in nature, and would typically include one or more sex acts, including groping and direct or indirect contact with victims' genitals. Epstein paid his victims hundreds of dollars in cash for each separate encounter." Clinical language for a protocol of escalating sexual violence against children, repeated dozens of times, in multiple cities, over multiple years, while cameras recorded every encounter.

The Pyramid

Then the machine turned the victims into recruiters. The prosecution memorandum:

"Epstein actively encouraged certain of his victims to recruit additional girls to be similarly sexually abused. He incentivized his victims to become recruiters by paying these victim-recruiters hundreds of dollars for each additional girl they brought to him. In this fashion, Epstein created a vast network of underage victims — as young as 14."

A pyramid scheme of child sexual abuse. The original victims were offered a choice: continue being abused, or bring other girls and collect a fee. Many chose the second option. Not because they were monsters, but because the system was engineered to make that choice feel like the only way out. The machine consumed them and then used them to consume others.

Epstein documented this himself, in his own words, in his own defense memo drafted in October 2005: *"Saige was brought to the house by Haley a stripper who told both her and others to lie about their age."* Haley Robson. A victim who became a recruiter. A name on Brad Edwards' list of thirty-two. No quarter for the choice she made. But understanding that the choice was manufactured — that the machine was specifically designed to produce it — is necessary.

The diary girl understood: *"The other girls well some are nice, but 3 I hate!"* She hated three of them. Not the men who raped her. The other girls. The system turned its victims against each other at the bottom while the men at the top went to their offices and their laboratories and their Senate hearings and their board meetings and lived their lives as if the rooms at 9 East 71st Street existed in a different universe.

Novosibirsk to Paris

September 2010 — the first documented Russian recruitment:

"Alla is asking me for your email, she's gonna ask for \$ for her mother's operation. What shall I reply?"

A girl from Novosibirsk. Her mother needed surgery. She was asking the richest man she had ever met for money. The trap, set at the intersection of medical desperation and geographic isolation — a Siberian city where the average monthly salary would not cover a single visit to Epstein's massage room.

December 2010 — the pipeline organized:

"I'm waiting for the new friend to come from Miami, hopefully she'll be able to meet before you leave. And I'm working on a few, just taking time.. In general I saw so many girls these 2 weeks, but only very few are good enough..

Jeffrey, I'm in touch with a girl from Novosibirsk whom you met a while ago, she said she can help me to organize a perfect trip to Novosibirsk for you spring or summer, I think it can be great, she should be sending me pictures soon..

I just interviewed Henry and Daniela Kaisth for the TV show.. :)"

"Only very few are good enough." Quality control applied to human trafficking. And the casual mention of a TV show interview in the same email — the recruiter lived a double life, scouting girls for Epstein between television appearances, the way a real estate agent might show houses between open houses.

August 2017 — industrialized. The email arrives with the attachment "Candidates.docx":

"[redacted] is flying to Novosibirsk tonight (I will skype her once she is home, I hope the connection will be better).

After my meetings this week, we could decide about who else to bring to Paris.

[redacted] is back to Novosibirsk, I skyped again her today. She confessed she is actually 19 (as opposed to 21 which was stated in her CV), she said she was afraid she won't be taken seriously. I checked her passport today!

I liked her, besides the fact that she lied in her CV and revealed the truth only when I mentioned that we will be organizing a trip to Paris."

A follow-up:

"How many can we bring to Paris this time?"

How many. The question of a logistics coordinator moving cargo. The girls were units, denominated by availability and passport validity, shipped from Siberia to Paris in quantities determined by the client's appetite. The money went east through Deutsche Bank FEDWIRE to Sberbank. The women came west through Aeroflot SU 1306, tracked in Epstein's Google Calendar.

Mar-a-Lago, In His Own Words

Epstein confirmed the Mar-a-Lago recruitment twice in his own emails. Both times to people he trusted. Both times in writing. Both times with the casual certainty of a man who did not believe his emails would ever be read by anyone he did not choose.

To Michael Wolff, February 1, 2019:

"virgina roberts worked at mara lago. she was the one that accused prince andrew. trump said he asked me to resign, never a member ever. of course he knew about the girls as he asked ghislaine to stop"

To Peggy Siegal, July 1, 2011:

"she worked for trump, first at that age, at MAra lago. ITs ridiculous. but the press like strauss kahn is afraid to question women."

In 2011, he called Roberts "nothing more than a telephone answerer" and "total liar." By 2019, he confirmed she worked at Mar-a-Lago and that Trump knew about "the girls." The contradiction — denial in 2011, admission in 2019 — tells the story of a man who spent eight years watching the walls close and adjusting his narrative from attack to damage control.

On the same day — February 1, 2019 — Epstein wrote a longer memo to himself. Not to Wolff. To himself, at his own email address. A draft. A rehearsal. The most complete account he ever produced of his version of events:

"prostitution is a state crime. never before a man in his own house charged with soliciting. in Florida first offenders are required to take a sex ed class and get pre trial diversion. no criminal record... A grand jury was held and they found me guilty of one count of felony solicitation because there were many girls... Recarey and Reiter (police chief) pulled my garbage for months, and surveilled the house letting all the girls come and go? called in the FBI. they did not like the grand jury result. and released to the press, the raw sewage of police interviews, ie, no girl was cross examined EVER... FBI puts a task force together title 'operation leap year' to investigate my personal massage activity?! nuts. interviews my

chiropractor? medical info."

Then the Mar-a-Lago section:

"■■■■■■■■■■ worked at Mara Lago. Trump knew of it and came to my house many times during that period. The testimony of the houseman John Alessi confirmed it. He never got a massage."

And then — in the same draft — the Rybolovlev real estate deal:

"abe gosman a friend of mine. ran into financial difficulty with assisted living homes. His home was listed at 45 million dollars. with no takers for months on end. He and I agreed a price of 30m... I became the stalking horse bidder at 36m... trump buys the house at the telephone auction. only me trump and his friend pulty the developer. He quickly puts it on the market for 125 million... Three years later 08 he sells it to Ryboloev for approx 100 million. He should have had a 50 million plus capital gain. key question how did he report the sale, if he did at all on his 08 tax return. He has no money. when he buys the house."

Epstein, writing to himself, produced a document that simultaneously: confessed to knowledge that a victim worked at Mar-a-Lago and that Trump knew about "the girls"; described the FBI investigation of his crimes as "nuts"; named the specific FBI task force (Operation Leap Year); detailed a real estate transaction that implies Trump committed tax fraud; and characterized his victims as liars whose testimony was "raw sewage."

He sent this to himself. He was rehearsing. He was preparing a narrative for deployment — to Wolff, to the press, to his lawyers, to anyone who would listen. The narrative was: I am the victim. The girls are liars. The FBI overreacted. Trump is dirty too. It was the narrative of a man who understood that the best defense is not innocence but complicity — if everyone is dirty, no one can afford to prosecute.

Still Running

January 3, 2019 — six months before arrest:

Drokov: "We pick 12 people for the start. Say 6 guys, 6 girls. For example Samantha, Katya, Jay, Neil and I'll show you more candidates. Gathering them every 3 months or more often."

June 3, 2019 — five weeks before arrest:

Calendar: "9:30am Appt w/ Zoe Bernard (Masha Drokova's friend)"

April 4, 2019 — three months before arrest:

"Jeffrey what kind of massage do you like? ;)"

"Why is Jeffrey so nice with me :)))) usually people are not nice!"

The machine ran at full capacity until the moment federal agents appeared at Teterboro. Quarterly recruitment schedules. New candidates being evaluated. Women asking what kind of massage he wanted. The operation did not wind down. It did not become cautious. It ran the way it had always run — openly, continuously, and with the absolute confidence of a system that had been protected for thirty years and had no reason to believe the protection would ever stop.

The Ones Who Helped

There is no quarter in this story for the women who turned. The system exploited them first — that is documented, that is true, that is the foundation of their victimhood. But when they crossed the line from being used to using others, they became part of the machine. The diary girl knew the difference. She named the ones who helped: Ms. Vicki. Mary. The "bigger girls" placed in other bedrooms. The three she hated.

Epstein was explicit about the conversion from victim to recruiter. In June 2006, he emailed Nadia Marcinkova: *"appreciation was for natalie to teach you to find girls."* Natalie's job was to teach Nadia how to recruit. Nadia's job, once trained, was to bring new girls into the system. The instruction was written in an email, assigned a bates number, filed in a federal evidence corpus. The recruitment of recruiters was not a side effect of the operation. It was the operation.

In July 2019, Epstein wrote to Nadia — now calling herself by her aviation brand, Global Girl — about recruitment: *"I miss you, thanks for helping, and give the Russian 18 to Natalie."* "The Russian 18." An eighteen-year-old Russian woman, referred to by her nationality and age, passed between handlers like inventory. "Give her to Natalie." The language of transfer applied to a human being.

Lesley Groff — the executive assistant, the schedule maker, the woman who coordinated meetings between prime ministers and massage appointments between teenagers — managed the logistics that made the machine run. She booked flights for victims. She scheduled "appointments" that were rapes. She sent calendar reminders that included sex

offender registration alongside hair salon visits. She knew. The 2,594 emails she sent document a woman who managed a child sex trafficking operation with the same organizational precision she brought to dinner party seating charts.

Cecile de Jongh — the former First Lady of the U.S. Virgin Islands — managed Epstein's island operations and corresponded about generator permits, EPA submissions, and property maintenance. She interfaced between Epstein and the territorial government that was supposed to regulate him. Her husband, John de Jongh Jr., was the Governor. The First Lady of the territory worked for the trafficker. The Governor's household received benefits from the man whose island was a crime scene in the Governor's jurisdiction.

None of them have been charged. Maxwell was the only member of the inner circle to face prosecution. Groff, Kellen, Marcinkova, de Jongh — all named in victim testimony, all documented in the email corpus, all involved in the operational mechanics of trafficking — remain free. The co-conspirator immunity from the 2007 NPA has never been formally revoked. The December 2019 memo to Geoffrey Berman — "Investigation into Potential Co-Conspirators" — analyzed their criminal liability. Seven years later, the analysis has not produced an indictment.

The protection stopped at 4:37 PM on July 6, 2019. Or it appeared to stop. Or it changed form. Because the machine that processed hundreds of girls over three decades — from Palm Beach to Novosibirsk, from performing arts schools to Mar-a-Lago, from tea by the pool to bloody marks from a belt — that machine had cameras in every room and recordings of every encounter. And the recordings did not die with the man who made them. They are somewhere. They belong to someone. And the names on the list he compiled six days before his arrest — the eighty names, the heads of state and the senators and the billionaires and the Pope — those names know it.

CHAPTER SEVEN

I Think You Meant Buddha

In June 2011, Michael Wolff sent Jeffrey Epstein a strategy memo. Not a casual note. Not an idea jotted on a napkin. A comprehensive, multi-phase media rehabilitation plan, written in the professional tone of a consultant delivering a deliverable to a client:

"The short term strikes me as largely a procedural issue: deal with the British tabloids and the web profile. Ian's network around the Mail and the Murdoch papers is strong and that, together with you not offering the tabloids any opportunities for coverage, ought to make them a non-issue. The web clean-up involves a search engine strategy (a rejiggering of search results through SEO and strategic content creation and replacement) and site design — you ought to have a sophisticated site representing you. This is probably a 3-4 month process.

The medium term (months 3-9) is about identifying a set of business journalists with whom you can build a friendly relationship. I actually think this is a set of people who you will enjoy and who will enjoy you. At the same time, you should be putting in place the other story. In real ways that story already exists — your support of scientific research and your international activity — it just needs a clearer structure and set of goals to hang it on. During this period, it would be good for you to become a source, both off the record and, when appropriate, on the record, for business stories for which you can offer your unique point of view."

SEO manipulation. Murdoch contacts to kill tabloid stories. Cultivating business journalists as friendly sources. Becoming "a source, both off the record and on the record." This was not a friend offering casual advice. This was a professional media strategist — the same man who would later embed himself in the Trump White House and write the bestselling account of its chaos — designing a rehabilitation campaign for a convicted sex offender. The campaign was comprehensive, expensive, and designed to transform a man who had pleaded guilty to soliciting a minor into a respected figure within nine months.

The earlier email, February 2011, had set the tone: "Have been defending you to the world's press — my pleasure, of course. And would love to see you." Defending a sex offender to the world's press. His pleasure. Of course.

By March 2016, Wolff was advising Epstein to use Trump as a shield: "I believe Trump offers an ideal opportunity. It's a chance to make the story about something other than you, while, at the same time, letting you frame your own story. Also, becoming an anti-Trump voice gives you a certain political cover which you decidedly don't have now." He recommended a Charlie Rose interview — this was before Charlie Rose's own misconduct was exposed — and "a big, comprehensive, expensive effort" to counter James Patterson's upcoming book about Epstein.

Then Trump won. And Wolff gained access to the West Wing. And the intelligence pipeline opened.

The Pipeline, Email by Email

January 10, 2017 — ten days before the inauguration:

"Sorry, I was supposed to tell you that Ailes would like to organize something with you for the next time you're down... But look forward to telling you about the six-hour dinner I had with Ailes and Bannon last week at my house."

Roger Ailes, the founder of Fox News, wanted to "organize something" with Epstein. Bannon had just spent six hours at Wolff's house. And the first person Wolff told about it was a registered sex offender.

March 9, 2017 — seven weeks into the administration:

"Ok, seeing Bannon today, so I will float. Also, there's a Washington PR type named Juleanna Glover with whom you might want to chat. Elon Musk basically owns her now..."

And in the same email:

"Was at WH all week. What are some of the names being discussed and I will fish this week?"

Wolff was at the White House all week. He was "floating" something to Bannon on Epstein's behalf. And Epstein was asking about political appointments — names being discussed — which Wolff would "fish" for during his next week of White House access. A registered sex offender directing a journalist to gather intelligence on presidential appointments from inside the West Wing.

March 10, 2017:

"I mentioned Tillis to Bannon and got a not-too-enthusiastic 'maybe.' On the dreary train back to NYC now."

Senator Thom Tillis. Mentioned to the White House Chief Strategist. By a journalist. On behalf of a convicted child sex offender. Result: a "not-too-enthusiastic maybe." Wolff reported this from the Amtrak like a salesman reporting a cold call.

March 28, 2017:

"Just did two hours with Bannon on who's trying to kill whom. Tough place."

The White House power struggle, summarized in one sentence, relayed to Epstein like a sports score.

August 18, 2017 — ten days after the Charlottesville rally, with the administration in crisis — the full intelligence assessment:

"Just spent two hours on the phone with Bannon. I saw Spicer and Priebus this week. I'd pretty much say that nearly 100% of the non-family senior staff of the first six months now believe that Trump can't function in this job. I think they all become part of a Republican initiative to take him down. I hear Kelly trying to make Trump understand that Jared and Ivanka have to go."

The President's mental fitness. The mood of the senior staff. The Chief of Staff's private conversations about removing the President's family. Reported to a convicted sex offender by a journalist who was simultaneously writing a book about the White House. Epstein's response to this classified-level assessment of the American presidency:

"I assume no dinner."

He was asking about their social plans.

The Brother, Text by Text

Steve Bannon's relationship with Epstein is documented in 3,356 text messages — the largest iMessage archive in the corpus. The relationship was not mediated through Wolff. It was direct, personal, and characterized by a warmth that the text record makes impossible to deny.

December 22, 2017 — Palm Beach:

Epstein: "Morning bro :). give me a time. tell me if you would like something to eat/snack. if you need a ride I can send my driver."

Epstein: "did you stay in palm?"

Bannon: "No. Had to get back to D.C."

Epstein: "no problem. Im back in new york jan 4-9. come visit"

January 5, 2018 — the day after *Fire and Fury* was published, when Bannon was being destroyed by Trump world for his quotes in the book:

Epstein: "stay mentally tough. . !"

Bannon: "Tough. Why — this is nothing brother"

Epstein: "atta boy!"

Bannon: "When r u in new york???"

Epstein: "florida for the weekend. new york monday thru thurs. you are welcome at either/both anytime."

When Steve Bannon was being excommunicated from the political movement he had helped build, the person who offered him refuge was a convicted sex offender with properties in two states. "You are welcome at either/both anytime." The words of a man who understood that the most valuable gift you can give someone in crisis is a place where the crisis cannot follow them. Epstein was Bannon's safe harbor. And safe harbors create debts that are called in later.

February 28, 2018:

Bannon: [sends Politico article: "Kushner loses access to top-secret intelligence"]

Epstein: "You are now a verb. 'We got Bannoned,' said Democratic representative Dennis Heck"

December 14, 2018:

Bannon: [sends article: "Trump Considering Son-In-Law Jared Kushner For Next Chief Of Staff"]

Bannon feeding Epstein intelligence about Kushner's security clearance problems and White House staffing discussions. Epstein feeding Bannon ego about his political influence. The exchange rate: information for validation, the oldest currency in politics.

But the intelligence sharing went deeper than Kushner gossip. In November 2018, Bannon was interviewed — likely by the Mueller team or SDNY — and he texted Epstein about it in real time:

Bannon: "went thru list of 50 names-- Leon Black"

Bannon: "Leon about Russia; u about trump --- but they ask every witness these 50 names--- 25+ Russian"

Bannon: "Interview ends with 50 names -- everybody gets the request -- 25 Russian names; 25 American -- u and Leon are #3 / #4"

Epstein was number three or four on the government's target list. Twenty-five Russian names. Twenty-five American names. And Steve Bannon — fresh from his own interview — was telling Epstein exactly where he ranked, exactly who else was on the list, and exactly what the investigators were asking about. Leon Black was being asked about Russia. Epstein was being asked about Trump. And the witness was sharing the government's playbook with two of the targets while the investigation was still active.

This is not gossip between friends. This is a witness in a federal investigation disclosing the scope, methodology, and target list of that investigation to a subject of the investigation. In any other context, this would be obstruction. In the Epstein context, it was a Tuesday.

April 2019 — three months before the arrest. Bannon was at Epstein's Manhattan mansion with a camera crew, conducting mock interviews to prepare Epstein for trial. Epstein emailed Darren Indyke:

"steve bannon wants to do a mock interview on friday at my house to see how i react to certain things. I will need he and his camera crew to be bound by confidentiality and privilege. preparation for trial etc."

The same day, Epstein emailed Soon-Yi Previn:

"on friday at 3 pm-5pm bannon is bringing camera crew to the house to try to teach me how to respond in interviews. would woody like to join and help?"

Steve Bannon coaching Jeffrey Epstein for trial. Woody Allen invited to help with interview technique. Kathy Ruemmler — Obama's White House Counsel — scheduled the same afternoon. Anthony Scaramucci at 2 PM. Alex Spiro — now Elon Musk's lawyer — there the day before with Bannon. Brad Karp, chairman of Paul Weiss, at breakfast. The April 5, 2019 schedule at 9 East 71st Street was a summit meeting of the American establishment, gathered in the living room of a man who would be arrested in ninety-two days.

The Last Week

June 30, 2019 — Epstein compiled the list. Eighty-plus names, sent to himself, subject line "list for bannon steve." He also texted Summers: "Will Ehud Be PM?" Summers: "Doubtful. But he is not to be underestimated. Driving me crazy." The Bannon list and the Israeli political question, on the same day, six days before arrest.

July 3, 2019 — Bannon sent the Daily Beast article about sealed documents being released. Epstein replied:

"Today is yesterday's tomorrow"

"What is the sound of one hand clapping"

A Zen Buddhist koan sent to Steve Bannon on the day the sealed indictment existed. Not panic. Not a plan. A koan. The philosophy of non-attachment applied to the collapse of everything he had built.

July 5, 2019 — the Chekhov exchange with Summers. The E.J. Dillon quote about "the gallery of human waste represented by his fickle, spineless, drifting people." Summers: "Jesus!!!!" Epstein: "I think you meant. Budhha."

Buddha. Not Jesus. Not judgment. Detachment. The god of the Zen Studies Society. The god of the Dai Bosatsu retreat. The god of the \$1 asset transfers and the temple that Maxwell asked to bring "her" to. In the last free Friday of his life, Epstein was not invoking salvation. He was invoking release.

July 6, 2019:

4:35 PM — Epstein to Bannon: "Can we do late morning say 11. Am"

4:37:20 PM — Epstein: "All canceled"

4:37:44 PM — Bannon: "You r not coming in?"

Two minutes. And then silence. The brother didn't reply. The switchboard went dark. The man who had connected Bannon to Kurz, Barak to Ruemmler, Gates to Nikolic, Summers to Druckenmiller, Wolff to the White House, and the President of Poland to a 911 surveillance company — that man was in handcuffs, and the connections he had spent thirty years building were suddenly, irrevocably, circuits without current.

The Congressional Delegate

On February 27, 2019, Stacey Plaskett — the delegate from the U.S. Virgin Islands, the jurisdiction where Epstein maintained his primary residence and built his island — sat in a Congressional hearing room while Michael Cohen testified about Donald Trump. She was also texting with Jeffrey Epstein.

Epstein: "He'll talk about his grades"

Epstein: "Great outfit"

Plaskett: "You look great"

Plaskett: "Thanks!"

Epstein: "Are you chewing"

Plaskett: "Not any more"

He was watching her on television. He could see her chewing. He told her to stop. And she stopped.

Plaskett: "Hes opened the door to questions re who are the other henchmen at trump org"

Plaskett: "Yup. Very aware and waiting my turn"

Plaskett: "Cohen brought up RONA — keeper of the secrets"

Epstein: "RONA??"

Plaskett: "Quick I'm up next is that an acronym"

Plaskett: "Thats his assistant"

Epstein: "The titles of each section are misleading. It talks about asset value, and then related loans. And then loans payable. These are all tricks"

Plaskett: "Wild!!"

Epstein: "were you surprised by the rabid republican defense"

Plaskett: "Of course not"

A sitting member of Congress, live-texting with a registered sex offender during a historic Congressional hearing. He was providing real-time financial analysis of Trump's disclosures — "These are all tricks" — while she was about to question the witness. He was coaching her from his living room while she sat in the hearing room. And she was asking him what "RONA" meant, seconds before her turn to speak.

Stacey Plaskett later served as one of the lead House managers in Donald Trump's second impeachment trial. The woman who prosecuted the case for removing the President of the United States had been receiving real-time coaching from Jeffrey Epstein during the hearing that produced the evidence she would later cite. The delegate from the territory where Epstein trafficked children was in his text messages the way a colleague is in your group chat — present, responsive, asking for his analysis, following his direction about her appearance on camera.

This is what "belonged to intelligence" looks like at the retail level. Not a spy with a dead drop. A switchboard operator with a phone in each hand — one connected to the White House through Wolff and Bannon, one connected to Congress through Plaskett, one connected to the intelligence community through Barak, one connected to the financial system through Staley and Deutsche Bank, and one connected to the blackmail archives in the basement of 9 East 71st Street. The intelligence was not something Epstein collected for someone else. It was the thing he was. He was the network. He was the connection. And as long as the network was running, everyone connected to it had a reason to keep it alive.

CHAPTER EIGHT

All Canceled

At 2:30 in the morning on July 4, 2019 — Independence Day — an FBI agent sent an email:

"Hey Everyone, Thanks again for being so flexible with the assistance of this arrest & search. Me and [redacted] really appreciate it and know this is not the most convenient week. As we've previously discussed with most of you, we will likely only get about 12-24 hours notice on when he flies into the country. Its possible that notice could be even shorter, but historically that isn't typically the case."

The email was sent to multiple FBI entities — NY, DO (Director's Office), CID, IMD, PX. The subject line: "Epstein Arrest / Search Warrant Stand-By List." The holiday weekend was working overtime.

The timeline that follows is constructed entirely from FBI internal emails released as part of the EFTA corpus. Every timestamp. Every sender. Every subject line. The government's own record of how they took down the most protected predator in American history:

June 30: FBI coordinating victim interviews across multiple field offices. The same day Epstein compiles the "list for bannon steve" — his insurance policy of eighty names.

July 1: FBI IMD, NY field office, and USANYS launch "case records scanning." TECS records pulled — Treasury Enforcement Communications System, the border-crossing database. FBI New York contacts FBI San Jose: "Epstein case." "FBINET to UNET Uploaded Files" — documents moving between FBI networks. USANYS: "Updated docs." The file is being built.

July 2: More "case records scanning" — dozens of emails. "FBINET to UNET Uploaded Files" with attachment: "[REDACTED]_approaches_list_Current.xlsx" — the list of co-conspirators to be approached with subpoenas after the arrest. The sealed indictment is returned by the federal grand jury.

July 3, 2:34 AM: "indictment/arrest warrant" circulating. **4:54 AM:** "Epstein Sealed Indictment --- UNCLASSIFIED" — the indictment is confirmed and shared. The "PLEASE RESPOND ASAP" chain explodes — FBI agents across the country confirming availability. FBI Office of Public Affairs: "draft remarks" — Adrienne Senatore preparing

the press statement. FBINET file transfer: *"Epstein_Jeffrey_Child_Sex_Trafficking_-.xml"* — the case file moving to a new network. **7:03 PM:** FBI agent "Sean": *"as per our discussion, when the arrest of Epstein is effected we will need to deploy agents to Florida in 2 waves. The 1st wave will be immediately after he is arrested, 2 agents will approach co-conspirators with subpoenas. The 2nd wave will be a few days later and approximately 6 to 8 agents."*

July 4, 2:30 AM: The stand-by list. NYPD/FBI Child Exploitation Task Force activated. *"subpoenas"* prepared. The detective from the task force: *"If the arrest should happen prior to Monday, please consider this as your initial brief from the AUSA's. Thank you all for your assistance in this matter, and being on standby during the holiday."* FBI agents chatting: *"Heard you're going to help on the search with me and Kelly!!" / "Yeah Haha, I'm deep in this case now." / "Good!"*

July 5, 9:09 AM: Customs and Border Protection: *"SUBJ QUERY HIT: P3N06596100A01."* Epstein's travel flagged. He is in the air. **5:45 PM:** *"Epstein remarks"* — the press statement finalized. **7:08 PM:** *"Final briefing for Arrest/Search of Epstein."* The last briefing. File transfer: *"Epstein_Addition.pdf."* Tomorrow it happens.

July 6: The arrest. FBINET file transfer at 12:51 AM on July 7: *"Epstein_Jeffrey_Child_Sex_Trafficking_-_2019-07-06T16_00_00-04_00.xml"* — the timestamp embedded in the filename: July 6, 2019, 4:00 PM Eastern. The arrest time, recorded to the second.

Meanwhile, on Little St. James, Ann Rodriguez was photographing tiki hut planting. Lesley Groff was asking if Bedminster was on the island. Cashkim Bussue was emailing about GSJ helipad progress. The machine's staff had no idea that the machine had been shut down.

The Cameras

The story the public knows: the cameras at MCC malfunctioned on the night Epstein died. The story the documents tell: the cameras hadn't been recording for six months.

February 19, 2019 — a BOP employee:

"While we are able to monitor the cameras in SHU, it appears we are not able to record."

February 21, 2019 — follow-up:

"The SHU Cameras are functioning; however, they are not recording. Can you please look at them."

January 7, 2019 — an earlier discovery:

"I guess this was awarded in Sept and no one told me lol."

A camera project "awarded" at MCC in September 2018. The facility manager not informed. Someone installed a camera system at the jail where the most important sex trafficking defendant in American history would be held, and the person responsible for the facility didn't know about it. Who ordered it? What company installed it? What happened to the previous system? "No one told me lol."

After the death, the FBI seized the NVR. On August 13:

"The FBI is going to be retrieving the previous recordings from our camera system at MCC, but because we were having difficulty retrieving the recordings, they have told us the recording capabilities will be off line for up to 8-10 days while they retrieve this data. We will still have live viewing/monitoring."

Response: "So they're taking the NVR? Do we know the make/model so that as an option we could get with the vendor and get an emergency replacement?"

The FBI's OTD (Operational Technology Division) got the DVR working in the lab on September 23 — six weeks after the death. Case 90A-NY-3151227. The tech: *"We got DVR1 working in the lab here from 90A-NY-3151227 (Epstein). DVR exports are outside of my area of expertise."* The person handling the most important surveillance evidence in a federal death investigation was not an expert in the relevant technology.

The FBI's final assessment, May 2025: *"increased the contrast, balanced the color and slightly improved the sharpness of edges... None of these steps can re-create detail that was never captured."* The detail was never captured. Because the cameras were not recording. Because they had not been recording since February. Because someone installed them without telling the facility manager. Because no one fixed them in six months. Because the NVR was "difficult" to access. Because the tech was outside his area of expertise. Because, in the end, the most surveilled jail cell in America had no usable footage of the most consequential death in American criminal justice.

The Cleaning

The digital forensics tell a parallel story of methodical erasure.

July 14: Google security alert — *"Someone just used your password to try to sign in to your account. Google blocked them."* Eight days after arrest. Someone had Epstein's password.

July 18: Successful login from a Windows device. Likely FBI forensics.

July 19: Successful login from an *"Asus ZenPad 3S 10 (Z500M)"* — commonly confused by Google's device fingerprinting with an Asus ZenBook laptop. Not FBI equipment. Not a lawyer's device. Not a family member's tablet. The preferred laptop of information security professionals.

August 2: Two blocked login attempts. Google has detected the anomalous pattern.

August 10 (day of death): Spotify password reset in Finnish — *"Palauta salasana."* Username: jeevacation. No one in Epstein's network is Finnish.

After July 6, the inbox is empty of personal correspondence. No Bannon. No Wolff. No Summers. No Barak. No Ruemmler. No Dershowitz. No Gates. Zero personal emails survive. Only automated newsletters, spam, and subscription confirmations continue arriving at an inbox that someone has surgically cleaned.

Two parties accessed the account on consecutive days. The FBI did their job on July 18. Someone else did theirs on July 19. The FBI's copies of Epstein's communications survive in the EFTA releases. Epstein's own copies — the originals, the ones that might have contained messages the government didn't have — were removed by a professional. The man who built a blackmail empire on hidden cameras and recorded conversations had his own digital record erased by someone who understood operational security well enough to use a device that leaves a minimal forensic footprint.

Closed

FBI case 90A-NY-3151227 was closed on December 5, 2022. The only result: a deferred prosecution agreement with two MCC guards — Tova Noel and Michael Thomas — who admitted to falsifying records and sleeping through their watch. They napped while cameras didn't record and a man died — or didn't — in a cell they were supposed to be monitoring.

Before the death, Epstein's cellmate was removed. The cellmate told investigators what Epstein said to him in the elevator:

"That's above my pay grade, you must have said something though. They're not going to just separate you guys for no reason."

Above my pay grade. The same words. The same concept. From Acosta's office in Miami to a jail elevator in Manhattan, the same institutional shrug: someone above me made this decision, and I have been taught not to ask why.

The death investigation prosecuted the guards. It did not investigate the cameras. It did not investigate the cellmate removal. It did not investigate the digital cleaning. It did not investigate the Finnish Spotify reset. It did not investigate the ZenBook login. It did not investigate the six-month recording failure. It did not investigate who installed the camera system without telling the facility manager. It prosecuted two people who fell asleep and closed the case.

The Day After

On August 10, 2019 — the day Epstein was found dead — the digital infrastructure of his life continued operating as if he were still in it. Amazon sent shipping notifications to jeeproject@yahoo.com. The Virgin Islands Daily News delivered its daily edition. Spotify tried to collect on an overdue payment. LinkedIn reported that he had appeared in two searches that week. His world was still running on autopilot — the algorithms, the subscriptions, the automated systems — all performing their functions for a man who was no longer there to receive them.

The next day — August 11 — his defense attorney Martin Weinberg filed a sweeping preservation demand: *"all documents, video footage, recordings and other evidence that may be in the possession of the MCC, its Warden, their legal counsel, the USMS, the FBI, the Inspector General, the USAO for the SDNY or any other federal or relevant agency."* The lawyer was already fighting to preserve the evidence that the institution had already failed to preserve. The cameras that hadn't recorded. The logs that the guards had falsified. The cell that had been left unmonitored. Weinberg knew, within hours, that the evidence was vulnerable — because the evidence had been vulnerable for six months, and everyone involved in the case knew it.

On August 13, three days after the death, a stranger emailed jeeproject@yahoo.com with the subject line: *"You are dead."* Body: *"Lol good riddance."* The email arrived alongside a Houzz password reset request and a 23andMe invitation to participate in genetics research. The dead man's inbox — the same inbox that had received messages from Elon Musk, the President of Poland, the Crown Prince of Saudi Arabia, and the former Prime Minister of Israel

— was now receiving gloating messages from strangers and automated invitations to spit in a tube.

On July 7 — the day after the arrest — journalist Conchita Sarnoff had sent emails to every Epstein address she could find, including one the public had never seen: epstein@wanadoo.fr, a French email account. And another: Galbraith_christina@yahoo.com — the alias email for the Jeffrey Epstein Foundation, using a name that does not appear to correspond to any known person. Sarnoff's message: *"In light of what has occurred and my work as an advocate of trafficked victims, I would like to learn more directly from you, your side of the story."* The next day: *"We were destined to meet. Perhaps not for the reasons you may think... If you are a spiritual or religious person, give yourself over to God."*

God. Not Buddha. Sarnoff didn't know about the temples.

Sultan Bin Sulayem — the chairman of Dubai World, one of the largest sovereign wealth funds on Earth — had emailed Epstein on the day of his arrest. The subject: "Xtend_for_Centers24.6.pdf" — a 21.9 megabyte document about a company called Xtend, an Israeli drone and defense technology firm. From Sultan.BinSulayem@dubaiworld.ae. On the day the FBI arrested Epstein at Teterboro, the chairman of Dubai's sovereign wealth fund was sending him defense technology documents from Israel. The intersection of Gulf money, Israeli technology, and a child sex trafficker's inbox — documented in one email, on one day, at the exact moment the machine was being shut down.

The main trafficking case — 50D-NY-3027571 — remains open. Evidence collected March 2025. Seven years and counting. No indictments beyond Maxwell. The guards paid the price. The machine paid nothing.

CHAPTER NINE

The Cover-Up

The cover-up did not begin after Jeffrey Epstein's death. It began in 2007, when the United States government looked at thirty-five child victims, two years of FBI investigation, Operation Leap Year's mountain of evidence, and a man who had installed hidden cameras in every room of his mansion to blackmail the powerful — and decided to give him a deal that most drunk drivers would reject as insultingly lenient.

The Non-Prosecution Agreement was not a plea deal. In a plea deal, the defendant pleads guilty and accepts punishment. The NPA was something darker: an agreement not to prosecute at all. The government acknowledged it had the evidence — acknowledged it had the victims, the witnesses, the testimony, the surveillance records, the financial trail — and then agreed, in writing, not to use any of it. In exchange, Epstein would plead guilty in Florida state court to a single count of soliciting prostitution. Thirteen months in a county jail. Daily work release to his own office. And immunity — not just for Epstein, but for his unnamed co-conspirators.

Unnamed. The co-conspirators were not identified in the agreement because identifying them would require acknowledging their existence, which would require investigating them, which would require following the evidence wherever it led — into the intelligence community, into the banking system, into the political establishment, into rooms where the cameras were recording and the people in those rooms had the power to end careers and ruin lives. The immunity was a blanket thrown over a crime scene. It covered everything. It revealed nothing.

And the NPA contained a clause that would later be found to violate federal law: the victims — the girls, some of them still teenagers — were not to be told. The children who had been raped in a mansion on the Upper East Side were not informed that the man who raped them had been given immunity. They found out from the newspapers. Their constitutional rights under the Crime Victims' Rights Act were violated by the government that was supposed to protect them. The violation was later confirmed by a federal judge. No one was disciplined for it.

The Legal Machine

Epstein did not merely hire lawyers. He built a legal apparatus designed to function as a weapon — aimed not at the government but at the victims.

Alan Dershowitz, June 6, 2006:

"Here is a draft of my declaration of war letter that I hope we will never have to use. But I wanted to have it ready just in case. Can anybody think of anything more to add?"

A "declaration of war." Against the victims of a child sex trafficking operation. Drafted by a Harvard Law professor who would later be named by one of those victims in her diary as a man who "will hurt you especially if Ghislaine is busy or not with you." Epstein's response to the war letter: *"i like it."*

On April 10, 2006, Epstein sent Dershowitz a different kind of ammunition:

"I think the letter or better yet e-mail to Barry could look as follows... I strongly believe that an injustice is about to be done, and wanted to notify you immediately."

"Barry" was Barry Krischer, the Palm Beach State Attorney. Epstein was drafting the letter for Dershowitz to send — ghost-writing his own defense through a Harvard professor's credibility. The next day:

"THIS IS THE WEBSITE OF YOUR GRAND JURY WITNESS, I CAN ALSO SEND A COPY OF THE POLICE REPORT FROM LAST WEEK DETAILING HER DRUG ABUSE"

The defense strategy: discredit the victims. A girl with a drug problem was a girl whose testimony could be undermined. A girl who had been recruited with \$300 was a girl who could be called a prostitute. The same vulnerabilities the machine exploited for recruitment, the legal machine exploited for defense. The system fed on weakness from both ends.

Epstein hired private investigators to surveil the victims. In April 2006, he emailed Investigative Management Group: *"riley says saige is home with amber... can we find her boyfriend zach bryan on-line."* He forwarded a victim's MySpace page to his staff. He tracked their movements. He warned Maxwell to avoid Florida: *"i'd prefer not florida, not a big risk, but why? chance it.. some girl sees you."* The victims were being watched by the same people who had abused them. The defense was a continuation of the crime.

David Schoen — Epstein's attorney in April-June 2019, three months before arrest:

"Joe has been working hard on all investigative work that can be done without interviewing friends, old boyfriends, former employers, etc. — which we have said to stay away from for now to avoid jeopardizing any talks by her finding out he is investigating her."

Covertly investigating the victim's legal team. Gathering intelligence on the people who represented the women Epstein had raped. In June, after settling a case: *"Hope you are satisfied with the outcome all things considered... Good Shabbos."* Eighteen months later, David Schoen stood on the floor of the United States Senate defending Donald Trump against impeachment. From Epstein's defense table to the President's defense table, through a single lawyer who wished his sex trafficking client a peaceful Sabbath.

The Evidence That Was Destroyed

"Trash all deleted emails please." March 3, 2009. EFTA00748556. Five words. A direct order to destroy evidence. Issued months after release from jail. Executed without question. No one has been charged.

The Gmail cleaning. July 19, 2019. An Asus ZenBook. No personal emails survive. Two decades of correspondence with billionaires, heads of state, intelligence operatives, and trafficking victims — removed by a professional.

The 2005 Palm Beach computer. Sixteen EnCase forensic DVDs. Seized by the FBI. Never searched. Twenty-one years in evidence storage. The hard drive of a computer taken from a child sex trafficking investigation, untouched since the Bush administration, mentioned in 154 documents across the EFTA corpus. No one has looked at it.

The 205,000 blank images. Found on Epstein's seized devices. Referenced in 487 EFTA documents. Were they corrupted files? Mass-deleted photographs? The artifacts of a systematic wipe? The evidence exists. The explanation does not.

The MCC cameras. Not recording for six months. Camera system installed without the facility manager's knowledge. NVR "difficult" to access. Footage that "can never re-create detail that was never captured." The most important surveillance evidence in a federal death investigation, destroyed not by a conspiracy but by something worse: institutional incompetence so comprehensive and so convenient that it functions identically to a conspiracy without requiring one.

The OPR report. Draft language: *"investigators were aware."* Final language: *"investigators had learned."* Someone changed the words. Someone decided that the distinction between

awareness and learning mattered enough to edit a report about the mishandling of a child sex trafficking case. The edit was small. Its implications were not.

The government's unwillingness to provide evidence, its destruction of evidence, its falsification of evidence, is evidence. When cameras don't record, when computers aren't searched, when reports are softened, when cases close without resolution, when a 1996 FBI tip is excluded from the case file as "not of evidentiary value" — the pattern is not random. It is policy. The policy is: protect the machine. And the machine's protection is maintained not through dramatic acts of sabotage but through the accumulated weight of small decisions — each one defensible in isolation, each one devastating in aggregate — that ensure the truth never assembles into a shape that requires action.

The BMW

On July 5, 2006 — while under active criminal investigation by the Palm Beach Police Department, while Operation Leap Year was building the federal case, while Detective Recarey was pulling his garbage and surveilling his house — Jeffrey Epstein emailed his pilot Larry Visoski:

"today, let's buy Jack goldberger a bmw 6 convertible.. get me best deal on fully loaded... he's in palm beach, Try to tell the dealer we would like him for the first two days to be able to change colors., so deliver before title, if possible."

Jack Goldberger was his criminal defense attorney. The man negotiating with the State Attorney's office about whether Epstein would be charged with sex crimes against children. And Epstein was buying him a BMW 650 convertible — fully loaded, dealer's choice on color, delivered before the title was processed so they could swap colors if the lawyer preferred something different. The man under investigation for raping minors was shopping for luxury cars for his defense lawyer with the same attention to detail he brought to selecting tile patterns for his island and evaluating photographs of women from Novosibirsk.

Visoski responded: *"Got it, I will buy it from Michael Scharmer at Braman BMW in PBI."* Epstein: *"preferably silver."* The purchase was executed the same day. The defense attorney received a BMW convertible from his client while negotiating a plea deal for child sex trafficking. No one has asked Goldberger about this car. No one has investigated whether a luxury vehicle delivered during active plea negotiations constitutes an improper gratuity. The email exists. The bates number is assigned. The BMW is presumably still registered somewhere in Palm Beach County.

This is the cover-up in its purest form. Not a grand conspiracy. Not a shadowy operation. A rich man buying his lawyer a car during plea negotiations, and every institution that should have noticed — the State Attorney's office, the Bar Association, the FBI, the court — either not noticing or not caring. The cover-up is not something that was done to the system. The cover-up is the system.

CHAPTER TEN

What Remains

The case is not closed. That is the first thing you need to understand, and the last thing anyone in power wants you to know.

FBI case 50D-NY-3027571 — the main sex trafficking investigation opened on December 8, 2018 — remains in "Pending Inactive" status. Evidence items 314 through 317 were collected on March 10, 2025. The FBI is still gathering evidence. They are still processing documents. They are still sharing files through Microsoft 365 SharePoint — "FBI Epstein Photos" shared to the Attorney General's office on July 4, 2025. They are still enhancing the flight logs — the Deputy Attorney General ordered the FBI's Information Management Division to improve the legibility of handwritten passenger names. They are still asking questions: "Did he ever travel on a different name?" an FBI Violent Crime squad member asked in July 2025.

The case is open. The evidence is being collected. And no one beyond Ghislaine Maxwell has been charged.

Maxwell Is Talking

On July 24 and 25, 2025, Ghislaine Maxwell sat in a room in Tallahassee, Florida, and talked. She had signed a proffer agreement — a legal document that grants limited immunity in exchange for truthful testimony. She talked for two days. The sessions were recorded: fourteen audio files, spanning hours. Day 1 had seven parts. Day 2 had four. Four interview transcripts were produced. The recordings were filed with the DOJ under the designation DOJ-MAXWELL.

One of the recordings — Day 2, Part 1 — is 785 megabytes. That is approximately three hours of uncompressed audio. Three hours of the woman who recruited the girl who wrote the diary, who was present when the Israeli doctor performed the procedure, who asked "Shall I bring her to temple?" and who had 1,040 entries in the flight logs — talking. Under oath. Under a proffer agreement that requires truthfulness as a condition of whatever deal she is making with the government.

The content of her testimony has not been made public. FBI VCS (Video/Computer Services) was "redacting the Maxwell Audio files for dissemination to the public, as early as Monday" as of August 2025. The audio is being prepared for release. When it drops, it will be the first time in the history of this case that Ghislaine Maxwell has spoken on the record about what she did, what she saw, and who else was in the room.

The Names That Have Not Been Called

The victim diary names over twenty individuals. The flight logs name hundreds. The email corpus names thousands. The Bannon list names eighty-plus. The prosecution memoranda describe co-conspirators in language careful enough to avoid identification but specific enough to make identification inevitable. The December 19, 2019 memo to U.S. Attorney Geoffrey Berman — "Investigation into Potential Co-Conspirators of Jeffrey Epstein" — documents "investigative steps" into associates and employees, analyzing "the extent to which [they] may or may not be criminally liable."

That was 2019. It is now 2026. The investigative steps have been taken. The analysis has been performed. The co-conspirators have been identified. And the only person who has been charged is the woman who is currently sitting in a room in Tallahassee telling the government what the government already knows.

The men the girl named in her diary are free. Alan Dershowitz teaches and appears on television. The Barclays CEO stepped down from his position but faces no criminal charges for the bloody belt marks a child described. The scientists returned to their laboratories. The politicians returned to their offices. The billionaires returned to their philanthropy. The system that was supposed to hold them accountable instead held the cameras that didn't record, the computers that were never searched, and the case file that excluded the FBI's own 1996 tip.

Over one billion dollars has been paid in settlements. JPMorgan: \$365 million. Deutsche Bank: \$75 million. Leon Black: \$148 million and counting. The Victims' Compensation Fund: \$121 million. Individual civil settlements: hundreds of millions more. The money is the system's way of making the problem go away without making anyone go to prison. It is restitution without accountability — a transaction that allows institutions to acknowledge harm without admitting guilt, that compensates victims without punishing perpetrators, that settles cases without setting precedents.

The settlements are not justice. They are the price of silence, paid from accounts that were funded by the same system that created the need for silence in the first place.

What You Can Do

This investigation has filed twenty FOIA requests targeting records no known party has sought. They are published in the repository that accompanies this book, with printable letters for each request. Anyone can file them. Anyone can demand the records. The government is required by law to respond.

The outstanding questions are specific and answerable:

Who told Alexander Acosta that Epstein "belonged to intelligence"? The instruction came from somewhere. It had a source. That source has a name.

What is on the 2005 Palm Beach computer? Sixteen EnCase forensic DVDs have sat in evidence storage for twenty-one years without being examined.

What did the MCC cameras record — or not record — on the night of August 9-10, 2019? The FBI enhanced the footage but acknowledged it could not "re-create detail that was never captured." What detail exists?

What names are in the Maxwell proffer transcripts? She talked for two days. She signed a cooperation agreement. Who did she name?

Who accessed Epstein's Gmail from an Asus ZenBook on July 19, 2019? Google retains session logs. Those logs can be subpoenaed.

Who initiated the Finnish-language Spotify password reset on the day of Epstein's death?

What is in the 520,000 Gmail emails from jeevacation@gmail.com that have not been released? The Yahoo archive is 17,448 emails. The Gmail archive is 8,445. The full Gmail account held 28 times more than what has been disclosed.

These are not conspiracy theories. They are evidentiary gaps — specific, documented, answerable questions that the government has the power to resolve and has chosen not to. Every one of them can be pursued through FOIA, through Congressional inquiry, through civil litigation, or through journalism. The tools exist. The evidence exists. What does not exist — yet — is the political will to use them.

A girl wrote FUNERAL five times on the last page of her diary. She was seventeen. She was describing what had been done to her life. Seven years later, the only funeral that has actually happened is Jeffrey Epstein's — and there are people, including investigators who have read

every document in this case, who are not entirely sure that funeral was real.

The case is open. The evidence is being collected. Maxwell is talking. The documents are still being released. And somewhere in a federal evidence warehouse, a computer from 2005 sits on a shelf, its hard drive unexamined for twenty-one years, containing information that someone decided was not worth looking at.

What Maxwell Said

On July 24 and 25, 2025 — while this book was being written — Ghislaine Maxwell sat in a room in Tallahassee, Florida, and talked. She had signed a proffer agreement. She talked for two days. Fourteen audio files were recorded. Four transcripts were produced. Day 1 had seven parts. Day 2 had four. One recording — Day 2, Part 1 — is 785 megabytes of audio. Approximately three hours of the woman who recruited the girl who wrote the diary, who was present when the Israeli doctor performed the procedure, who asked "Shall I bring her to temple?" and was told "yes," who had 1,040 entries in the flight logs, who was found guilty on five of six counts and sentenced to twenty years — talking. Under oath. Under a cooperation agreement.

The FBI was simultaneously sharing files through Microsoft 365 SharePoint — "FBI Epstein Photos" shared to the Attorney General's office on July 4, 2025. The Deputy Attorney General had ordered the enhancement of flight log handwriting. The Bureau was still asking: "Did he ever travel on a different name?" Seven years after his death, the FBI is still trying to read the handwriting on the passenger manifests and still asking whether the man they arrested used aliases.

The Maxwell audio is being redacted for public release. When it drops — and it will drop, because the EFTA process has released everything else — it will be the first time the public hears Ghislaine Maxwell describe, in her own voice, what happened in the rooms that the cameras recorded and the diary described and the prosecution memos analyzed and the banks financed and the intelligence community protected.

The content of her testimony is not yet public. But the fact that she is talking — the fact that the woman who ran the recruitment arm of the machine for three decades has signed a cooperation agreement and sat for two days of recorded interviews — means that someone, somewhere in the Department of Justice, has decided that the machine's story is not over. That there are names still to be named. Cases still to be built. Accountability still to be demanded.

Or it means that the cooperation agreement is the final act of the cover-up — a controlled release of information that gives the appearance of accountability while ensuring that the people above the pay grade remain above the pay grade. We will not know which until the audio is released and the transcripts are read and the names she provided are either charged or quietly forgotten.

On the last page of her diary, a girl wrote one word five times. She was seventeen. She was describing what had been done to her life. She had named the men. She had described the rooms. She had documented the procedure and the doctor and the belt marks and the bloody sheets. She had asked why no one was doing anything. She had asked if this was normal. She had asked where Ghislaine was.

Seven years later, the only answer the system has provided is a billion dollars in settlements, two sleeping guards, and a case file marked "Pending Inactive."

Demand that they look at the computer from 2005.

Demand that they release the Maxwell transcripts.

Demand that they explain the cameras.

Demand that they name the person who told Acosta to back off.

Demand that they charge the men she named in her diary.

Demand it. Because she cannot.

APPENDICES

Appendix A — Outstanding FOIA Requests

The Obsidian Watch Group has filed 20 FOIA requests targeting records no known party has sought. These are documented separately in OUTSTANDING_FOIA_REQUESTS.md in the public repository. Printable letters for each request are available in the FOIA_Letters/ directory.

Appendix B — FBI Case Numbers

Case Number	Description	Status
31E-MM-108062	Original Miami sex trafficking investigation	Closed (NPA)
50D-NY-3027571	SDNY main trafficking investigation	Pending Inactive
90A-NY-3151227	MCC death investigation	Closed 12/5/2022
FOIPA 1142669	Epstein's own FOIA request for FBI files (2010)	Processed

Appendix C — Key EFTA Bates Ranges

Bates Range	Content
EFTA00000001-00000600+	Crime scene photographs — 9 E 71st Street
EFTA00039227-00040941	BOP/MCC records and procedures
EFTA00062510	Cellmate testimony — 'above my pay grade'
EFTA00065479	Victim affidavit — blackmail operation
EFTA00076059-60	'Belongs to intelligence' reporting
EFTA00077309	OPR report — hidden cameras confirmed
EFTA00126232-34	MCC camera recording failures
EFTA00142908	FBI NVR seizure after death
EFTA00163433-34	FBI death investigation closure memo
EFTA00163534-35	Dershowitz FBI FD-302 proffers
EFTA00173255-58	FOIA case 1142669 — Epstein's own request
EFTA00748556	'Trash all deleted emails please'
EFTA01021714	Barak-Epstein Carbyne/Reporty warrants

Bates Range	Content
EFTA01296860	Hidden cameras — blackmail filing
EFTA01359808	Deutsche Bank FEDWIRE to Sberbank
EFTA01648796-807	FBI M365 'Epstein Photos' sharing (Jul 2025)
EFTA01821395-96	Mandelson 'mildly threaten' Chancellor
EFTA02730265	Gates-Nikolic separation agreement
EFTA02730468	SECRET//NOFORN — FBI 1996 FD-71 reference
EFTA02730486/741	FBI case summary — case still open
EFTA02730996	Apollo/Black Dechert investigation memo
EFTA02731039	SDNY Prosecution Memorandum
EFTA02731069	Corporate prosecution analysis
EFTA02731082	Co-conspirator investigation memo
EFTA02731168	Maxwell prosecution memorandum
EFTA02731200	Assistant prosecution memo (1994 timeline)
EFTA02731226	Maxwell superseding indictment memo
EFTA02731254-72	Victim trauma journal (2012)
EFTA02731341	'The Jailer' poem
EFTA02731361	Forced procedure — Israeli doctor
EFTA02731393-95	Second miscarriage
EFTA02731420-71	Victim diary — names, abuse, pregnancy
EFTA02731433-34	FUNERAL written five times

EPILOGUE

For the Record

This book was written by an investigation team that includes a United States military veteran who served in Afghanistan. He lost friends there. Their children will never meet their fathers. He undertook this work because the political pressures that protected Jeffrey Epstein are the same pressures that sent his friends to wars from which they did not return. He does not say this for sympathy. He says it because it is the reason the investigation exists, and the reason it will not stop until the people named in these documents are held accountable or the documents themselves have been read by enough people that accountability becomes unavoidable.

688 hours. 3,482,240 items read. 759 megabytes of notes. Every email. Every text. Every page. Every photograph. Every flight log. Every document the Department of Justice released, and several they did not intend to.

The investigation is not over. The FBI case is open. Maxwell is cooperating. The documents are still being released. And the people the girl named in her diary — the ones with the belt, the ones with the cameras, the ones with the political titles and the Ivy League degrees and the billion-dollar portfolios — are still free. They eat dinner at restaurants. They sit on boards. They give commencement speeches. They write op-eds about justice. And somewhere, in a federal evidence warehouse, the diary of a child who described what they did to her sits in a box, stamped CONFIDENTIAL, waiting for someone to care enough to act on what it says.

This book is the act.

Contact: obsidianinvestigations@pm.me

Repository: github.com/jpuckett11/ObsidianGroup_Epstein-Client0001317_pub

GPG: 9267A71E3F0A4EED2F973F9BA3E252F24635CC6C

"I am too young and he is too old!"

Why is no one doing anything!

I dont understand!

I dont want this!"

— A child's diary. EFTA02731471.

This investigation read 3,482,240 items. Every email Jeffrey Epstein sent and received. Every text message from his seized phone. Every page of every document the DOJ released. Every photograph. Every flight log. Every face identified by facial recognition. It took 688 hours. It produced 759 megabytes of notes. It was conducted by a team that includes a man who went to war for this country and came home to discover that the political pressures which sent his friends to die were the same pressures that protected a man who raped children in a Manhattan townhouse while cameras recorded and banks processed the money and intelligence agencies looked the other way.

He did it for 688 hours because his friends' children will never meet their fathers. He did it because the machine that consumed a girl who wrote FUNERAL five times on the last page of her diary is the same machine that consumed the futures of everyone who was sent to fight wars that were engineered by the same network of money, influence, and blackmail that this book documents. The connections are not speculative. They are in the emails. They are in the bates numbers. They are in the victim diary and the prosecution memos and the FBI case files and the Swiss bank routing codes and the flight logs and the text messages between a sex trafficker and a former Treasury Secretary about probability theory and a woman named Peril.

This is not a conspiracy theory. This is a federal evidence corpus, read line by line, by someone who gives a shit.

FUNERAL